





Curriculum Stories

English

الصف الحادي عشر

Term 1

One story for every lesson: enjoy the story and learn the whole lesson

24 stories

How to use this book

📚 One story per lesson

Each story teaches a whole lesson from your book, in the same order.

🖍️ Highlighted words

Highlighted words are the key words of the lesson.

💡 Facts

Small boxes inside the story give facts you should remember.

📖 Words

At the end of each story you find the key words with their meaning in Arabic.

🌟 What did I learn?

A short list of what the lesson teaches. Read it to check yourself.

🤔 Little questions

Try to answer alone, then look at the answer.

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Lesson 1-1 · Body Language

The Silent Detective

A mystery story | Theme 1: Communication

👥 Khalid, a Grade 11 student in Muscat, and his uncle Saif, a retired police officer

Khalid had a **job interview** on Saturday. It was only a summer job at a bookshop, but he was worried.

"I don't know what to say," he told his uncle Saif.

Uncle Saif smiled. He was a police officer for thirty years. "Words are only half of the story," he said. "Come with me. Today you will be a detective. A silent detective."

At the café

They sat in a busy café in Muttrah. "Look at people," said Uncle Saif, "but don't listen to them. Read their **body language**."

"What is body language?" asked Khalid.

"It is the way we move our bodies, our **gestures** and our **facial expressions**. We send **signals** all the time, even when we don't speak. And many people do not realise they are doing it."

Khalid looked at a young man near the door. He was looking at his watch again and again. His foot was moving under the table. He was crossing his arms.

"He is waiting for someone," said Khalid. "And he is... worried?"

"Good! Crossing your arms and moving your foot **nervously** are signals. People who feel nervous often avoid **eye contact** too."

> 💡 We send body language signals all the time, even when we don't speak. They show what we really think and feel.

Who needs this skill?

"Did you use body language in the police?" asked Khalid.

"Every day. A police officer notices when someone is feeling guilty. His eyes move away. He touches his face. Teachers use it too. Your teacher knows when students are bored or confused. She sees their faces before she hears a word."

Khalid laughed. "So Mr Hamed knows when I am bored in maths!"

"Of course he does."

The rules change

At the next table, two old friends were talking. One man touched the other man's shoulder and laughed loudly.

"Is that the same in every country?" asked Khalid.

"No! This is important. Body language is not the same everywhere. It changes with culture, and with who you are with. A gesture that is friendly in Oman can be rude in another country."

Practice time

Back home, Uncle Saif put a chair in the middle of the room. "Now you are at the interview. Walk in."

Khalid walked in slowly with his eyes on the floor. He sat down and put his hands between his knees.

"Stop!" said his uncle. "Your body says: I am afraid. Try again. Walk with purpose. Smile. Look at me. Sit up."

Khalid tried again. He walked in, smiled, made eye contact and sat up straight.

"Now you look **confident**!"

A detective's notebook

That night Khalid wrote new words in his notebook. His English teacher's tip was: to find a word with a similar meaning, first decide its **part of speech**.

anxiously (adverb) = nervously (adverb)

uninterested (adjective) = bored (adjective)

gestures = noun (plural)

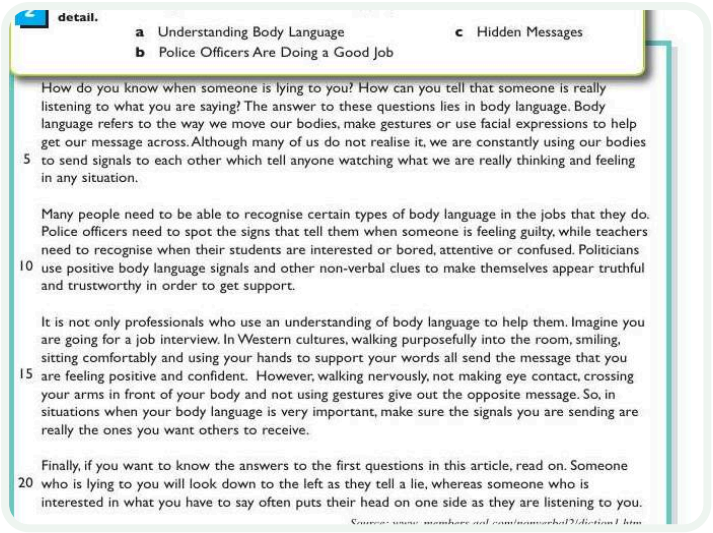
He also remembered another tip: skim first for the main idea, then read again for details.

❁ ❁ ❁

On Saturday, Khalid walked into the bookshop with purpose. He smiled and looked at the manager. The manager smiled back.

"You look like a confident young man," she said.

Khalid smiled again. The silent detective got the job.



detail.

a Understanding Body Language
b Police Officers Are Doing a Good Job
c Hidden Messages

How do you know when someone is lying to you? How can you tell that someone is really listening to what you are saying? The answer to these questions lies in body language. Body language refers to the way we move our bodies, make gestures or use facial expressions to help get our message across. Although many of us do not realise it, we are constantly using our bodies to send signals to each other which tell anyone watching what we are really thinking and feeling in any situation.

Many people need to be able to recognise certain types of body language in the jobs that they do. Police officers need to spot the signs that tell them when someone is feeling guilty, while teachers need to recognise when their students are interested or bored, attentive or confused. Politicians use positive body language signals and other non-verbal clues to make themselves appear truthful and trustworthy in order to get support.

It is not only professionals who use an understanding of body language to help them. Imagine you are going for a job interview. In Western cultures, walking purposefully into the room, smiling, sitting comfortably and using your hands to support your words all send the message that you are feeling positive and confident. However, walking nervously, not making eye contact, crossing your arms in front of your body and not using gestures give out the opposite message. So, in situations when your body language is very important, make sure the signals you are sending are really the ones you want others to receive.

Finally, if you want to know the answers to the first questions in this article, read on. Someone who is lying to you will look down to the left as they tell a lie, whereas someone who is interested in what you have to say often puts their head on one side as they are listening to you.

Reading text: Understanding Body Language

📖 Words from the story

body language
لغة الجسد

gesture
إيماءة / إشارة باليد

facial expression
تعبير الوجه

signal
إشارة

confident
واثق

nervously
بتوتر

eye contact
التواصل بالعين

job interview
مقابلة عمل

part of speech
نوع الكلمة (اسم، فعل، صفة...)

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Body language is how we move our bodies, our gestures and our facial expressions
- ✔ We send signals all the time, and many people do not realise they are doing it
- ✔ Police officers notice guilt
- ✔ teachers notice when students are bored or confused
- ✔ At a job interview: walk with purpose, smile, make eye contact and sit up to look confident
- ✔ Crossing your arms or avoiding eye contact can show you are nervous
- ✔ Body language changes with culture and with who you are with
- ✔ To find a similar word, first decide its part of speech: anxiously = nervously, uninterested = bored

🤔 Little questions

1. What is a gesture?
   Answer: A movement of part of your body to show what you mean
2. Name a sign of nervousness
   Answer: Crossing your arms or avoiding eye contact
3. What part of speech is "nervously"?
   Answer: Adverb
4. Is body language the same everywhere?
   Answer: No, it changes with culture



Lesson 1-2 · The Internet + Present Simple and Present Continuous

Grandfather Goes Online

A family comedy Theme 1: Communication

👥 Nasser, his grandfather Abdullah in Sohar, and Nasser's cousin Ahmed

Every Friday, Nasser visits his grandfather in Sohar. Grandfather Abdullah **lives** in an old house with a big garden. He **drinks** coffee every morning and he **reads** the newspaper every day.

But this Friday was different. When Nasser arrived, his grandfather **was sitting** in front of a new laptop.

"Grandfather! What **are** you **doing**?"

"I **am learning** about the **Internet**," he said proudly. "Your cousin Ahmed **is teaching** me this week."

What is it?

"So tell me," said Grandfather, "what is this Internet?"

Nasser sat down. "It connects millions of computers around the world. A man called **Tim Berners-Lee** created the **worldwide web** in **1991**."

"1991? That is not very old!"

"No, but it is the fastest growing technology in history. Now it is **essential** for many people."

> 💡 Tim Berners-Lee created the worldwide web in 1991. It is the fastest growing technology in history.

What can you do online?

Ahmed came in with tea. "Grandfather wants to try everything!"

"First," said Nasser, "**e-shopping**. People buy things online."

"And **blogging**," said Ahmed. "People write their ideas on a blog. There **are** many blogs on the Internet."

"And e-mail, and **social networking**, to talk to friends."

Grandfather looked around. "But where is the cable?"

"There isn't one. It's **wireless**. Wireless systems connect people almost everywhere."

Two kinds of present

Later, Nasser was doing his English homework. Grandfather looked at the page.

"Present simple... present continuous... what is the difference?"

Nasser smiled. "You are a good example, Grandfather. Listen.

You **drink** coffee every morning. That's a habit, so I use the **present simple**.

You **live** in Sohar. That's a fact, a permanent state. Present simple again.

But right now, you **are learning** about the Internet. That's happening now, so I use the **present continuous**.

And Ahmed **is teaching** you this week. That's a temporary situation. Present continuous."

"And plans?" asked Grandfather.

"Plans for the future also use the present continuous. For example: I'm getting a new phone tomorrow."

Ahmed laughed. "No, Grandfather is getting a new phone tomorrow!"

Key words

Nasser wrote two lists on a piece of paper.

always, usually, every day → present simple

now, at the moment, today → present continuous

"There is one more thing," he said. "Some verbs don't like the continuous. They are called stative verbs, like know, like and want. We don't say I am knowing the answer. We say I know the answer."

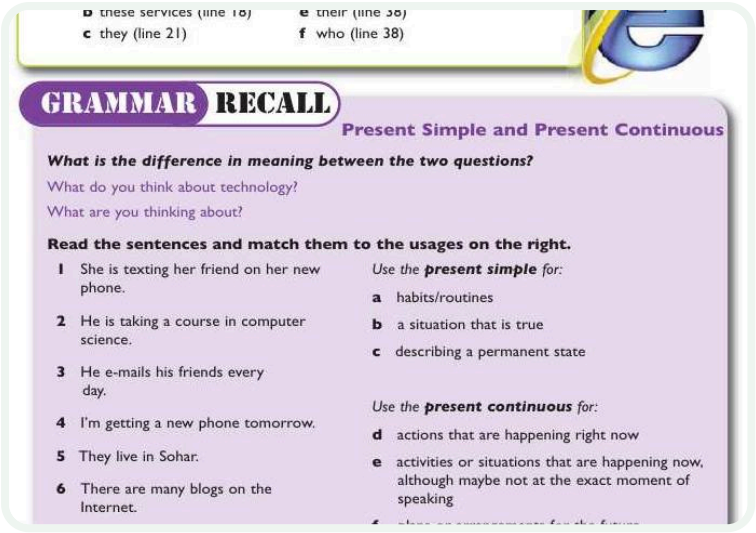
Grandfather nodded. "I know. You see? I **know**!"

A message from Sohar

The next week, Nasser's phone beeped. It was an e-mail from his grandfather.

Dear Nasser, I usually sit in the garden in the afternoon. But at the moment I am sitting in front of my laptop and I am writing to you! I am buying a book online today. I like the Internet very much. See you on Friday.

Nasser showed his mother. "Look! Grandfather uses the present simple and the present continuous perfectly!"



b these services (line 18) e their (line 38)
c they (line 21) f who (line 38)

GRAMMAR RECALL

Present Simple and Present Continuous

What is the difference in meaning between the two questions?

What do you think about technology?

What are you thinking about?

Read the sentences and match them to the usages on the right.

1 She is texting her friend on her new phone.
2 He is taking a course in computer science.
3 He e-mails his friends every day.
4 I'm getting a new phone tomorrow.
5 They live in Sohar.
6 There are many blogs on the Internet.

*Use the **present simple** for:*

a habits/routines
b a situation that is true
c describing a permanent state

*Use the **present continuous** for:*

d actions that are happening right now
e activities or situations that are happening now, although maybe not at the exact moment of speaking

Grammar Recall: Present Simple and Present Continuous

📖 Words from the story

worldwide web
الشبكة العنكبوتية العالمية

blogging
التدوين

e-shopping
التسوق الإلكتروني

social networking
التواصل الاجتماعي

wireless
لاسلكي

essential
ضروري

present simple
المضارع البسيط

present continuous
المضارع المستمر

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Tim Berners-Lee created the worldwide web in 1991
- ✔ it is the fastest growing technology in history
- ✔ People shop, blog, e-mail and use social networking online, and wireless systems connect people almost everywhere
- ✔ Present simple: habits (He e-mails his friends every day), facts (They live in Sohar), permanent states
- ✔ Present continuous: actions happening now, temporary situations, and future plans (I'm getting a new phone tomorrow)
- ✔ Key words: always, usually, every day → present simple
- ✔ now, at the moment, today → present continuous
- ✔ Stative verbs (know, like, want) are not usually continuous: "I know the answer"

🤔 Little questions

1. Who created the worldwide web?
   Answer: Tim Berners-Lee
2. When?
   Answer: In 1991
3. Which tense for a plan tomorrow?
   Answer: Present continuous
4. Choose: I usually (cook / am cooking) breakfast.
   Answer: cook
5. Correct this: "I am knowing the answer."
   Answer: I know the answer.



Lesson 1-3 · Mobile Phones and SMS Language

The Radio Phone-in

A radio story Theme 1: Communication

👥 Majid, a student who calls a radio programme, the presenter Hilal, and three other callers

Every Thursday evening, Majid listens to a radio programme called Your Opinion. This week, the topic was mobile phones.

"Good evening, listeners," said the presenter, Hilal. "Tonight's question: are mobile phones good or bad? Call us and give us your **opinion**!"

Caller one: Mr Rashid

The first caller was an old man. "I **can't stand** mobile phones!" he said. "On the bus, people **blab** on their phones all the time. It's **noise pollution**! And there is less **privacy**. Everybody hears everybody's business. And they are very costly, too."

"Thank you, Mr Rashid. A strong opinion!"

Caller two: Dr Salma

The second caller was a doctor. "I think mobile phones are **marvellous**," she said. "Last year, a man had an accident on the road to Nizwa. A young driver used his phone to call the ambulance. In an **emergency**, a phone can save a life."

"Thank you, Dr Salma."

Caller three: Majid

Majid's hand was shaking, but he called. "Hello, I'm Majid. I'm a student. I think phones are useful. I use mine to keep in touch with my family. But I want to talk about something else: SMS language."

"Go on," said Hilal.

"My little brother writes messages like this: CU 2MORO. THX! My teacher says it is a kind of **abbreviation**, a short form of a word."

> 💡 An abbreviation is a short form of a word: Dr = doctor, info = information, IT = information technology.

The SMS quiz

Hilal laughed. "Let's make a quiz for our listeners! Majid, what does 2MORO mean?"

"Tomorrow."

"And L8R?"

"Later."

"GR8?"

"Great!"

"PLS, THX, RU?"

"Please, thanks, are you."

"And the last one: B4N."

Majid thought for a moment. "Bye for now!"

"Excellent! And CU?"

"See you!"

Hilal added some normal abbreviations: "In my university days, I wrote uni for university and dept for department. And of course, USA is the United States of America."

The important rule

"But Majid," said Hilal, "can you use SMS language everywhere?"

"No," said Majid. "My teacher says: use SMS language only with friends. In e-mails to teachers or companies, write full words. And never in an exam or a formal letter. Always use standard English in formal writing."

"Wise advice!"

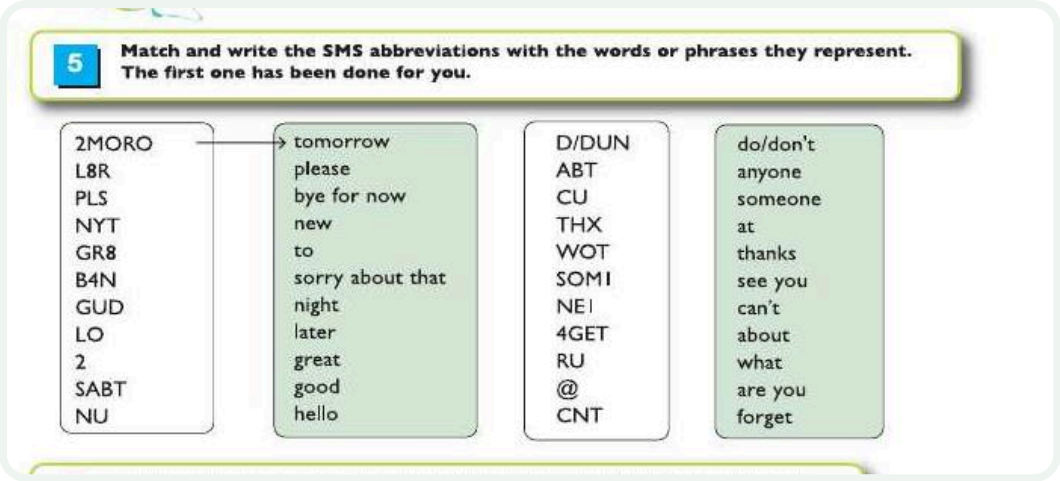
The last caller

The last caller was a woman. "I agree with everybody! Phones are useful in an emergency and to keep in touch with family. But I want to **get rid of** the noise. Please, everybody: speak quietly in public places!"

❁ ❁ ❁

After the programme, Majid's phone beeped. It was a message from his brother: U WR GR8 ON RADIO!

Majid smiled and wrote back in standard English: Thank you! See you tomorrow.



SMS abbreviations

📖 Words from the story

abbreviation
اختصار

opinion
رأي

can't stand
لا يطيق

blab
يثرثر

marvellous
رائع

get rid of
يتخلص من

noise pollution
تلوث ضوضائي

privacy
خصوصية

emergency
حالة طارئة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Mobile phones have advantages and disadvantages
- ✔ Good: useful in an emergency and to keep in touch with family
- ✔ Bad: noise pollution, less privacy, and they are costly
- ✔ An abbreviation is a short form of a word: Dr, info, IT, uni, dept, USA
- ✔ SMS language: 2MORO = tomorrow, L8R = later, PLS = please, GR8 = great, B4N = bye for now, THX = thanks, CU = see you, RU = are you
- ✔ Use SMS language only with friends
- ✔ always use standard English in formal writing and exams

🤔 Little questions

1. What does B4N mean?
   Answer: Bye for now
2. What is an abbreviation?
   Answer: A short form of a word
3. One advantage of mobile phones?
   Answer: Useful in an emergency
4. Write in standard English: "CU 2MORO. THX!"
   Answer: See you tomorrow. Thanks!



Lesson 1-4 · Communication Skills

The Boy Who Said "Yes" and "No"

A friendship story Theme 1: Communication

👥 Yousef, a quiet boy, and his new neighbour Faisal

Yousef was a quiet boy. When people asked him questions, he gave very short answers.

"Did you like the match?"

"Yes."

"Are you going to the beach?"

"No."

Then the conversation stopped. Yousef didn't know why people walked away.

A new neighbour

One day, a new family moved into the house next door. Their son, Faisal, came to say hello.

"Hello! How are you? I'm Faisal."

"Fine," said Yousef.

Faisal smiled. "Nice to meet you! We moved from Ibri. Do you like football?"

"Yes."

Faisal waited. Yousef said nothing. Faisal laughed kindly. "You know, a conversation is like football. If I pass the ball to you, you must pass it back!"

The secret of conversation

The next day, they sat on the wall between the two houses. Faisal explained.

"My father says good communication means two things: talking **and** listening. **Relationships** are two-sided. Each person must be heard."

"But what do I say?" asked Yousef.

"First, show interest. Nod your head. Say 'mm' or 'Really?' Second, make **eye contact**. Third, **take turns** talking and listening. Fourth, don't just answer 'yes' or 'no'. And the most important one: ask a question about what the other person just said."

> 💡 A good listener asks a question about what the speaker just said.

Practice

"Let's try," said Faisal. "I went to Jebel Shams last week."

Yousef thought. "Really? That's interesting. Was it cold?"

"Very cold! We saw the canyon. What do you think? Should I go again in winter?"

"Yes, I think so... and how about me? Can I come too?"

Faisal laughed. "Perfect! You showed interest, you asked a question, and you gave more than 'yes'."

Bad news

A week later, Faisal looked sad.

"What's wrong?" asked Yousef.

"I've lost my mobile phone."

Yousef remembered the rules. "Oh no! I'm sorry to hear that. Where did you last see it?"

"In the mosque car park, I think."

"Let's go and look together."

They found the phone under a car. Faisal hugged his new friend. "You are a good listener now."

Feelings

That evening, Yousef's father noticed something. "You are talking more, son."

Yousef nodded. Then he said something he never said before. "Father, I was unhappy at school last term. Some boys laughed at me."

His father put down his cup. "Why didn't you tell me?"

"I don't know. I kept it inside."

His father said gently, "**Pent-up** feelings, feelings you keep inside, can make you unhappy. When you **share** a problem, you feel better. That's why we communicate: to know what others want and how they feel, and to **express** our own **feelings**."

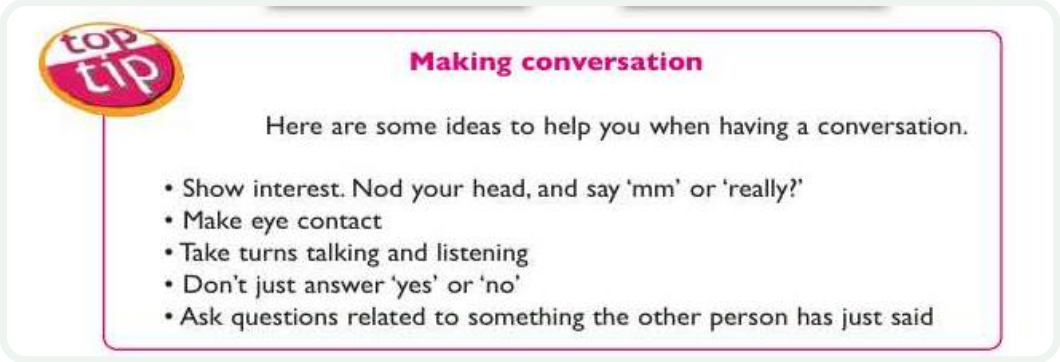
❁ ❁ ❁

The next morning, Yousef met Faisal at the bus stop.

"Hello! Nice to see you!" said Yousef. "How about you? Did you sleep well?"

Faisal smiled. "Who are you, and what did you do with the quiet Yousef?"

They both laughed. "See you later!" they said at school, and this time the conversation never stopped.



Top tip: Making conversation

📖 Words from the story

relationship علاقة	**express** يعبّر
feelings مشاعر	**pent-up** مكبوت
take turns يتناوب	**share** يشارك
eye contact التواصل بالعين	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Good communication means talking and listening
- ✔ We communicate to know what others want and how they feel
- ✔ relationships are two-sided, each person must be heard
- ✔ Pent-up feelings can make you unhappy
- ✔ sharing a problem makes you feel better
- ✔ Conversation tips: show interest (nod, "mm", "really?"), make eye contact, take turns, don't just answer "yes" or "no", ask about what the other person just said
- ✔ Everyday phrases: Nice to see you! / Really? That's interesting. / I'm sorry to hear that. / What do you think? / How about you? / See you later!

🤔 Little questions

1. Name two conversation strategies
   Answer: Eye contact and taking turns
2. What does "pent-up" mean?
   Answer: Kept inside, not expressed

3. Your friend says "I've lost my phone." What do you say?

   Answer: I'm sorry to hear that. Where did you last see it?

4. Respond to good news

   Answer: That's interesting! / How exciting!

The E-mail Disaster

A comedy in e-mails · Theme 1: Communication

👥 Musallam, a student who breaks every e-mail rule, and his teacher Mr Hamad

Musallam loved writing e-mails. The problem was: he wrote them very badly.

Disaster one

On Monday, Musallam sent an e-mail to his teacher, Mr Hamad. It had no subject line, and it said:

> PLEASE SEND THE HOMEWORK!!! I DONT HAVE IT!!! 😀😀😀

Mr Hamad wrote back:

> Dear Musallam, why are you shouting at me?

Musallam was confused. "I wasn't shouting!" he said to his friend Saeed.

Saeed looked at the screen. "You wrote everything in **capital letters**. In an e-mail, capitals look like shouting. And smileys to a teacher? Use smileys only in very informal e-mails."

Disaster two

On Tuesday, Musallam wanted to invite three friends to football. He sent the e-mail to everyone in the school, all two hundred students. The next day, sixty boys came to the small football pitch.

"Don't send it to people who don't need it!" shouted the angry coach.

Disaster three

On Wednesday, he sent his mother a very long e-mail, eight hundred words about his day. At the end she wrote:

> Hi Musallam, I stopped reading after the first paragraph. Love, Mum.

"Keep your e-mail short!" laughed Saeed.

Disaster four

On Thursday, Musallam's friend asked for his password for the school website. Musallam sent it by e-mail.

Mr Hamad called him to his office. "Musallam, never send **confidential** information by e-mail. A password is secret."

The ten rules

Mr Hamad gave him a piece of paper. "Read this. These are the Ten Rules for Writing E-mails."

1. Think carefully before you write.
2. Keep your e-mail short.
3. Don't send it to people who don't need it.
4. Think about who you are writing to.
5. Check spelling, grammar and **punctuation**.
6. Don't write in CAPITALS. It looks like shouting.
7. Use "smileys" only in very informal e-mails.
8. Include a **subject line**. It's the most important part.
9. Don't send confidential information.
10. Don't mark e-mails **urgent** unless they really are.

💡 The subject line is the most important part of an e-mail. Never leave it empty.

Musallam read rule ten and went red. Every one of his e-mails was marked URGENT, even the one about lunch.

Formal or informal?

"And rule four," said Mr Hamad. "Think about who you are writing to. To your mother, write informally: Hi Mum, and finish with Love, Musallam. To me, or to a company, write formally: Dear Mr Hamad, and finish with Best regards, Musallam Ali. Choose the **appropriate** style."

Friday: a new Musallam

On Friday, Mr Hamad opened his inbox. There was an e-mail with a clear subject line: Question about Unit 1 homework.

Dear Mr Hamad,

I hope you are well. Could you please tell me the page number for the homework?

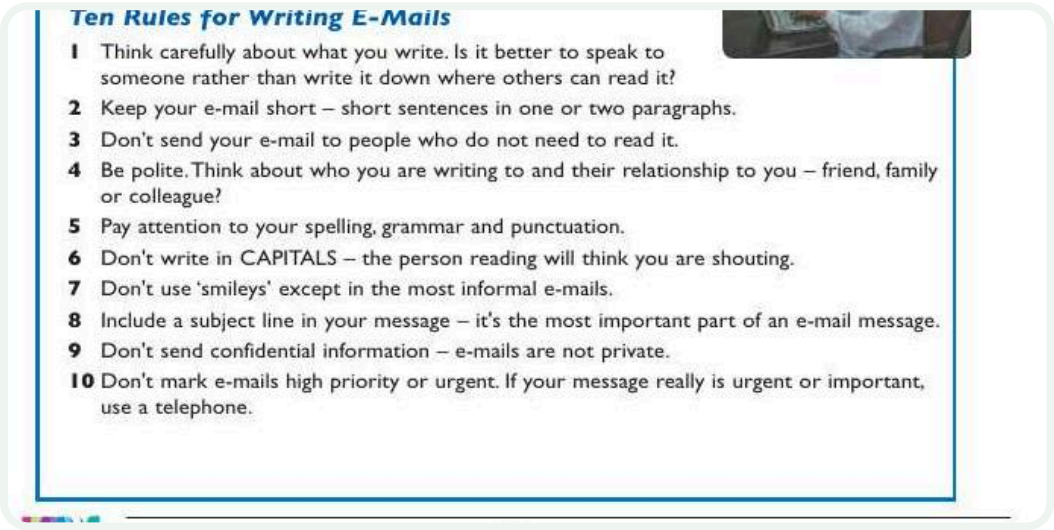
Best regards,

Musallam Ali

It was short, clear and polite. Before he clicked Send, Musallam read it once more, and checked the spelling, grammar and punctuation.

Mr Hamad smiled and wrote back:

Dear Musallam, Page 10. Excellent e-mail! Best regards, Mr Hamad.



Ten Rules for Writing E-Mails

1. Think carefully about what you write. Is it better to speak to someone rather than write it down where others can read it?
2. Keep your e-mail short – short sentences in one or two paragraphs.
3. Don't send your e-mail to people who do not need to read it.
4. Be polite. Think about who you are writing to and their relationship to you – friend, family or colleague?
5. Pay attention to your spelling, grammar and punctuation.
6. Don't write in CAPITALS – the person reading will think you are shouting.
7. Don't use 'smileys' except in the most informal e-mails.
8. Include a subject line in your message – it's the most important part of an e-mail message.
9. Don't send confidential information – e-mails are not private.
10. Don't mark e-mails high priority or urgent. If your message really is urgent or important, use a telephone.

Ten Rules for Writing E-mails

📖 Words from the story

subject line سطر الموضوع	**punctuation** علامات الترقيم
confidential سري	**urgent** عاجل
appropriate مناسب	**capital letters** الحروف الكبيرة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ E-mails should be short, clear and polite
- ✔ Ten rules: think first, keep it short, send only to people who need it, think about the reader, check spelling, grammar and punctuation
- ✔ Don't write in CAPITALS (it looks like shouting) and use smileys only in very informal e-mails
- ✔ Include a subject line: it's the most important part
- ✔ Don't send confidential information and don't mark e-mails urgent unless they really are
- ✔ Informal: Hi Mum, … Love, Musallam. Formal: Dear Mr Hamad, … Best regards, Mohammed Ali
- ✔ Before you click Send, read your e-mail once more

🤔 Little questions

1. Why not use CAPITALS?
   Answer: It looks like shouting
2. What is the most important part of an e-mail?
   Answer: The subject line
3. Should you send a password by e-mail?
   Answer: No, it is confidential
4. Which rule is broken in "PLEASE SEND THE MONEY"?
   Answer: Rule 6: Don't write in capitals



Lesson 1-6 · Across Cultures: The United Kingdom

Letters from Edinburgh

A story in letters Theme 1: Communication

👥 Hamza, an Omani student studying in Scotland, and his younger brother Ali in Nizwa

Letter 1: Ali to Hamza

Dear Hamza,

How is life in England? Is it cold? Please write and tell me everything about England for my school project.

Your brother, Ali

Letter 2: Hamza to Ali

Dear Ali,

Thank you for your letter. But first, a small correction: I am not in England! I am in Scotland, in the city of **Edinburgh**. Many people make this mistake.

Let me explain. The official name of this country is **the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland**. We call it the UK. It has four countries: **England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland**.

Great Britain is an island with three countries on it: England, Scotland and Wales. The UK is Great Britain plus Northern Ireland.

Each country has its own capital: London is the capital of England and of the whole UK. Edinburgh is the **capital** of Scotland, Cardiff is the capital of Wales and Belfast is the capital of Northern Ireland.

Write soon,

Hamza

💡 Great Britain = England, Scotland and Wales. The UK = Great Britain + Northern Ireland.

Letter 3: Ali to Hamza

Dear Hamza,

Sorry! So you are English now?

Ali

Letter 4: Hamza to Ali

Dear Ali,

Ha ha! No, I'm Omani! But here is another lesson: "English" and "British" are not the same. English people are from England. British people are from any part of the UK. My friend Callum is Scottish, so he is British but not English!

Some facts for your project: the languages are **English, Gaelic and Welsh**. The money is the **Pound Sterling**. And the UK has a **parliament** in London where laws are made.

People have a **stereotype** about the British: they think everyone drinks tea and talks about the weather. Some do, of course! But a stereotype is a fixed, simple idea about a group of people, and it is often wrong.

Hamza

Letter 5: Ali to Hamza

Dear Hamza,

My teacher asked us to read about a famous British person. I chose William Shakespeare. Have you heard of him?

Ali

Letter 6: Hamza to Ali

Dear Ali,

Of course! Last weekend my class visited **Stratford-upon-Avon**, the small town where Shakespeare was born in **1564**. He was a great English **dramatist**, a writer of plays. He wrote more than **35 plays** and **150 poems**.

His plays are of three kinds. A **tragedy** is a sad play with an unhappy ending, like Hamlet and Macbeth. A **comedy** is a funny play with a happy ending. And histories are plays about kings and past events. He died in **1616**, but people still read his work today, four hundred years later.

Now a question for you. Compare with Oman: how is Oman organised? What are its regions and languages? Tell me in your next letter!

Your brother,

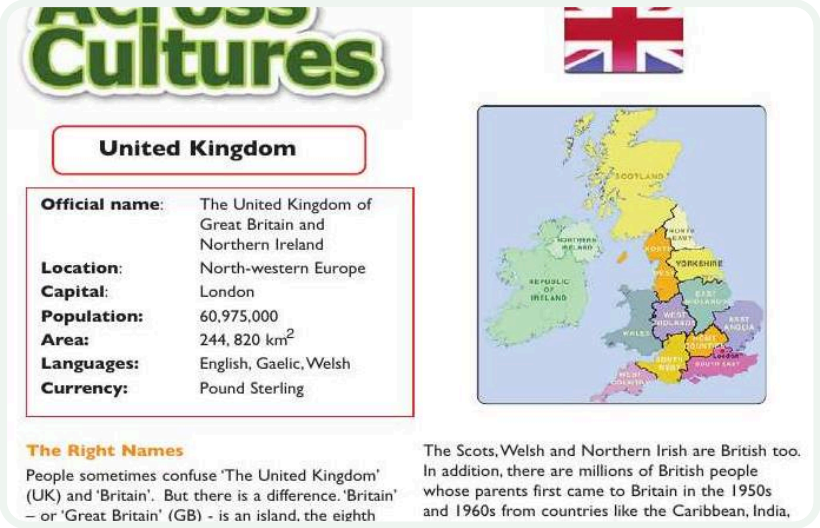
Hamza

Letter 7: Ali to Hamza

Dear Hamza,

Oman has governorates, like Muscat, Dhofar and Ad Dakhiliyah. Arabic is our official language, and some people also speak other languages, like Mehri in Dhofar. Our capital is Muscat. My teacher gave me full marks!

Ali



Across Cultures: United Kingdom fact file

📖 Words from the story

capital
عاصمة

parliament
برلمان

stereotype
صورة نمطية

dramatist
كاتب مسرحي

tragedy
مأساة

comedy
ملهاة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The UK's official name is the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
- ✔ its capital is London
- ✔ It has four countries: England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland, with capitals London, Edinburgh, Cardiff and Belfast
- ✔ Great Britain is an island with England, Scotland and Wales
- ✔ the UK also includes Northern Ireland
- ✔ Languages: English, Gaelic and Welsh
- ✔ currency: Pound Sterling
- ✔ English people are from England
- ✔ British people are from any part of the UK
- ✔ Shakespeare was born in 1564 in Stratford-upon-Avon, wrote more than 35 plays and 150 poems (tragedies, comedies, histories like Hamlet and Macbeth) and died in 1616

🤔 Little questions

1. What is the capital of Scotland?
   Answer: Edinburgh
2. How many countries are in the UK?
   Answer: Four
3. When was Shakespeare born?
   Answer: 1564
4. What is the difference between Great Britain and the UK?
   Answer: Great Britain is England, Scotland and Wales
5. the UK also includes Northern Ireland

Lesson 2-1 · Goodbye to Childhood

The Jacket That Got Small

A coming-of-age story Theme 2: Those Teenage Things

👥 Talal, aged 14, his older brother Sultan, and their mother

At the start of the school year, Talal put on his winter jacket. It was too small! The sleeves stopped in the middle of his arms.

"Mum! Somebody made my jacket smaller!"

His mother laughed. "Nobody made it smaller, Talal. You got bigger. You grew ten centimetres this year!"

The growth spurt

His older brother Sultan, who was studying biology at university, looked up from his book.

"That's a **growth spurt**," he said. "It's a quick, noticeable increase in height and weight. It happens in **adolescence**."

"Adolescence?"

"The stage between childhood and adulthood. It is a **transition**, from about **13 to 19**. Your body is changing because of changes in your **hormones**. And did you know? Girls often begin their growth spurt earlier than boys. Our cousin Mariam was taller than you last year, remember?"

Talal remembered. He didn't like that memory!

💡 Adolescence is the stage between childhood and adulthood, about 13 to 19. It brings physical and mental changes.

Changes inside

A week later, Talal had a bad day. In class, he answered a question wrongly and some boys laughed. He went red. At home he was angry with everyone. Then, one hour later, he was laughing at a video.

Sultan sat next to him. "Mood swings," he said.

"What?"

"**Mood swings**: happy, then angry, then sad, in one day. They are common for teenagers. And you felt very embarrassed in class, right? Teenagers become self-conscious and easily

embarrassed. They also often think they are very important, as if everyone is watching them."

"Everyone WAS watching me!"

Sultan smiled. "Not as much as you think, brother."

"So adolescence is not only about the body?"

"No. It also changes your thinking, your feelings and your relationships."

Friends and family

On Friday, Talal wanted to go to the mall with his friends instead of visiting his grandmother.

"But we visit Grandmother every Friday," said his mother.

"I'm not a child anymore! I want to be with my friends!"

There was a **conflict** in the house that evening. Later, his father talked to him quietly.

"Son, it's natural. Teenagers want independence, and friends become very important. But you still need your family's support. Choosing friends over family can cause family conflict. Can you find a balance?"

Talal thought. "I'll visit Grandmother in the morning and meet my friends after Asr."

"That's a mature answer."

Feeling good about yourself

That night Talal asked Sultan, "What about **peer pressure**? Some boys want me to do silly things to be 'cool'."

"Peer pressure is when people your age push you to do things. The answer is **self-esteem**: feeling you are a person of value. When you respect yourself, you don't need to copy others."

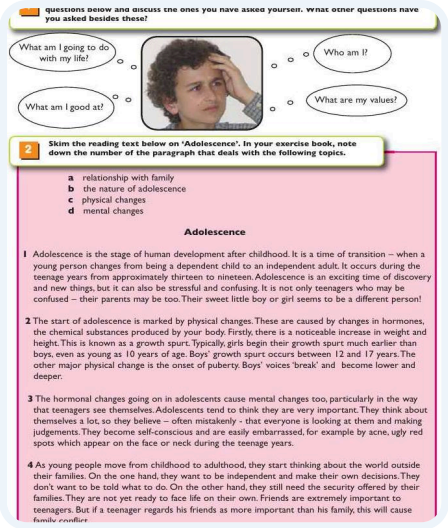
The main ideas

Before bed, Talal read a text about adolescence for homework. He remembered his teacher's tip: to find the main ideas, read the first sentence of each paragraph.

Paragraph one: Adolescence brings physical changes. Paragraph two: Teenagers also have mental changes. Paragraph three: Relationships with family and friends change.

"I'm living this text!" he said.

In the morning, Talal gave the small jacket to his little brother. "Goodbye, childhood," he said with a smile.


questions below and discuss the ones you have asked yourself. What other questions have you asked besides these?

What am I going to do with my life?

Who am I?

What am I good at?

What are my values?

2 Skim the reading text below on 'Adolescence'. In your exercise book, note down the number of the paragraph that deals with the following topics.

a relationship with family
b the nature of adolescence
c physical changes
d mental changes

Adolescence

1 Adolescence is the stage of human development after childhood. It is a time of transition – when a young person changes from being a dependent child to an independent adult. It occurs during the teenage years from approximately thirteen to nineteen. Adolescence is an exciting time of discovery and new things, but it can also be stressful and confusing. It is not only teenagers who may be confused – their parents may be too. Their sweet little boy or girl seems to be a different person!

2 The start of adolescence is marked by physical changes. These are caused by changes in hormones, the chemical substances produced by your body. Firstly, there is a noticeable increase in weight and height. This is known as a growth spurt. Typically, girls begin their growth spurt much earlier than boys, even as young as 10 years of age. Boys' growth spurt occurs between 12 and 17 years. The other major physical change is the onset of puberty. Boys' voices 'break' and become lower and deeper.

3 The hormonal changes going on in adolescents cause mental changes too, particularly in the way that teenagers see themselves. Adolescents tend to think they are very important. They think about themselves a lot, so they believe – often mistakenly - that everyone is looking at them and making judgements. They become self-conscious and are easily embarrassed, for example by acne, ugly red spots which appear on the face or neck during the teenage years.

4 As young people move from childhood to adulthood, they start thinking about the world outside their families. On the one hand, they want to be independent and make their own decisions. They don't want to be told what to do. On the other hand, they still need the security offered by their families. They are not yet ready to face life on their own. Friends are extremely important to teenagers. But if a teenager regards his friends as more important than his family, this will cause family conflict.

Reading: Adolescence

📖 Words from the story

adolescence المراهقة	**transition** انتقال / تحول
growth spurt طفرة نمو	**hormone** هرمون
self-esteem تقدير الذات	**mood swings** تقلب المزاج
peer pressure ضغط الأقران	**conflict** خلاف

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Adolescence is the transition between childhood and adulthood, about 13 to 19
- ✔ Physical changes: changes in hormones and a growth spurt (a quick increase in height and weight)
- ✔ girls often start earlier than boys
- ✔ Mental changes: teenagers think they are very important, become self-conscious and easily embarrassed, and have mood swings
- ✔ Teens want independence but still need family support
- ✔ friends become very important
- ✔ Choosing friends over family can cause family conflict
- ✔ Adolescence is not only about the body: it changes thinking, feelings and relationships
- ✔ To find the main ideas, read the first sentence of each paragraph

🤔 Little questions

1. When does adolescence happen?
   Answer: About 13 to 19
2. What is self-esteem?
   Answer: Feeling you are a person of value
3. What can cause family conflict?
   Answer: Choosing friends over family
4. What is a growth spurt?
   Answer: A quick increase in height and weight during adolescence



Lesson 2-2 · Teens and Adults + Past Simple and Past Continuous

The Sleeping Student

A school story Theme 2: Those Teenage Things

👥 Nasser, a tired student, his teacher Mr Hamed, and Nasser's father

It **was** Monday morning, and Mr Hamed **was explaining** an important lesson. The sun **was shining** through the window and the students **were writing** in their notebooks. But Nasser **was falling** asleep.

His head went down... down... down... and then: BANG! His book **fell** on the floor.

Everybody **laughed**. Mr Hamed **didn't laugh**.

"Nasser, please stay after class."

The conversation

After the lesson, Mr Hamed sat with Nasser.

"What **were** you **doing** last night?"

Nasser looked at the floor. "I **was chatting** on the Internet."

"Until when?"

"Until half past two."

Mr Hamed was quiet for a moment. "Nasser, your exams start next week. I'm not angry, but I'm worried about your **behaviour**. You need more sleep before the exams."

At home

That evening, Nasser's father was **suspicious**. "Why did your teacher call me?"

Nasser told him the story. His father's face was serious. "Each of us has a **point of view**," he said. "Let me hear yours first."

Nasser explained: "My friends are online at night. If I'm not there, I miss everything."

His father listened. Then he said, "Now here is my point of view. Your health and your studies are more important. Let's **resolve** this together. Can we make an **agreement**?"

They agreed: no Internet after ten o'clock on school nights, and an hour online on Thursday evening.

💡 Past continuous (was/were + -ing) = a long action in progress. Past simple = a completed or short action.

Grammar in real life

The next day, Mr Hamed used Nasser's story for the grammar lesson. He wrote on the board:

> Nasser **was falling** asleep in class. (an action in progress in the past)
>
> His book **fell** on the floor. (a short, completed action)
>
> Nasser **was falling** asleep **when** his book **fell**.

"When a long action is interrupted by a short one," said Mr Hamed, "we use the **past continuous** for the long action and the **past simple** for the short one. We connect them with when or while."

He wrote more examples:

> I was doing my homework when my friend knocked on the door.
>
> She was wearing a lovely dress.
>
> In March 2009, Oman won the Gulf Cup.

"The last one is a completed action: past simple. We make it with verb + **-ed**, or an irregular form like went or saw. The past continuous is **was** or **were** plus verb **-ing**."

A small trap

Saeed raised his hand. "Teacher, can I say I was knowing Nasser since primary school?"

"No," said Mr Hamed. "Know is a stative verb. We don't use it in the continuous. Say I knew him."

A practice question

"Now, choose," said Mr Hamed. "We (were having / had) dinner when there (was / was being) a power cut."

Nasser answered first, wide awake. "We were having dinner when there was a power cut."

"Excellent!"

A role-play

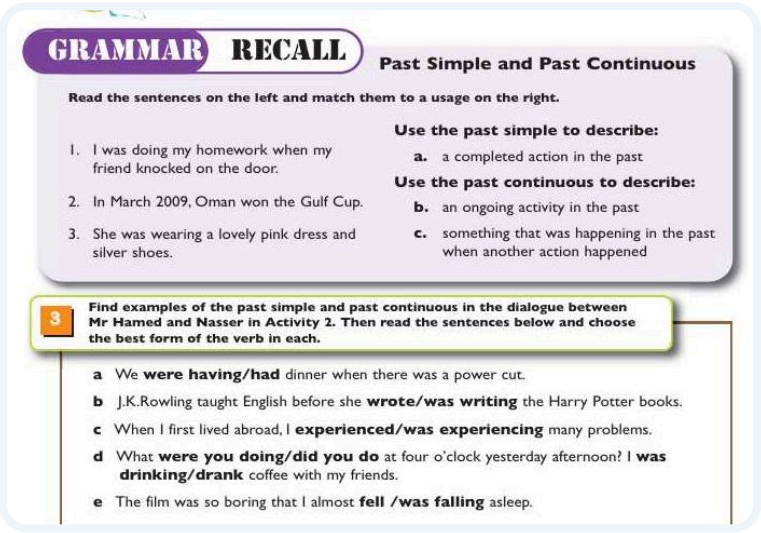
At the end of the class, the students did a role-play: one student was a parent, and one was a teenager.

"Where were you at midnight?" asked the "father".

"I was sleeping, of course!" answered Nasser. Everybody laughed, and this time Mr Hamed laughed too.

❁ ❁ ❁

One week later, Nasser walked out of his English exam smiling. He slept well the night before. His father **snored** loudly in the next room, but even that didn't wake him up!



GRAMMAR RECALL — **Past Simple and Past Continuous**

Read the sentences on the left and match them to a usage on the right.

1. I was doing my homework when my friend knocked on the door.
2. In March 2009, Oman won the Gulf Cup.
3. She was wearing a lovely pink dress and silver shoes.

Use the past simple to describe:
- **a.** a completed action in the past

Use the past continuous to describe:
- **b.** an ongoing activity in the past
- **c.** something that was happening in the past when another action happened

3 **Find examples of the past simple and past continuous in the dialogue between Mr Hamed and Nasser in Activity 2. Then read the sentences below and choose the best form of the verb in each.**

- **a** We **were having/had** dinner when there was a power cut.
- **b** J.K.Rowling taught English before she **wrote/was writing** the Harry Potter books.
- **c** When I first lived abroad, I **experienced/was experiencing** many problems.
- **d** What **were you doing/did you do** at four o'clock yesterday afternoon? I **was drinking/drank** coffee with my friends.
- **e** The film was so boring that I almost **fell /was falling** asleep.

Grammar Recall: Past Simple and Past Continuous

📖 Words from the story

suspicious يشك	**snore** يشخر
behaviour سلوك	**agreement** اتفاق
resolve يحل	**point of view** وجهة نظر
past simple الماضي البسيط	**past continuous** الماضي المستمر

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Parents and teachers worry about teenage behaviour
- ✔ listening to each other's point of view helps resolve problems
- ✔ Past simple = a completed action in the past: In March 2009, Oman won the Gulf Cup. Form: verb + -ed or irregular (went, saw)
- ✔ Past continuous = an ongoing action in the past: She was wearing a lovely dress. Form: was/were + verb-ing
- ✔ Long action (past continuous) interrupted by a short action (past simple), linked by "when" or "while": I was doing my homework when my friend knocked
- ✔ Stative verbs like "know" are not used in the continuous: "I knew him"
- ✔ In the dialogue, Nasser was falling asleep because he was chatting online until 2:30, and Mr Hamed advised more sleep before the exams

🤔 Little questions

1. Form of the past continuous?
   Answer: was/were + -ing
2. Use of the past simple?
   Answer: A completed action
3. Why was Nasser tired?
   Answer: He chatted online until 2:30
4. Choose: We (were having / had) dinner when there (was / was being) a power cut.
   Answer: were having, was



Lesson 2-3 · Teenage Friendships

Dear Lonely

A story in letters | Theme 2: Those Teenage Things

👥 "Lonely", a 16-year-old boy, and the school magazine team (Bader, Omar and Hassan)

Every month, the school magazine has a problem page. This month, the team, Bader, Omar and Hassan, opened a letter that made them quiet.

The letter

Dear Problem Page,

I am 16 years old. I have a big problem: I can't **maintain** friendships. I make a friend, and after a few weeks he stops talking to me. Now I feel **lonely**. I have no one to share my problems with. At break time, I sit alone and look at my phone. Other boys have a **circle of friends**. Why don't I?

Lonely

What makes a good friend?

"Before we answer," said Bader, "let's think. What makes a good friend?"

Omar took a pen. "He is **loyal**. He doesn't leave you when things are difficult."

"Honest," said Hassan. "He tells you the truth."

"**Trustworthy**," said Bader. "You can tell him a secret, and he keeps it."

"Kind and helpful," said Omar. "And a good listener."

💡 A good friend is loyal, honest, trustworthy, kind and helpful, and a good listener.

Bader's story

Bader was quiet for a moment. "Last year, I was like Lonely. Do you know why I lost friends? I talked only about myself. And once I said something **hurtful** about a boy's clothes. I was joking, but he was hurt."

"What changed?" asked Hassan.

"I joined the school science club. We worked together every week. I started to listen and to ask questions. Slowly, I had friends to **hang out** with."

Writing the answer

The team wrote their answer together. They used phrases for **giving advice**.

Dear Lonely,

Thank you for your letter. You are not alone. Many teenagers feel like this.

You should join a school club. You will meet boys with the same interests, and it is easier to make friends when you do things together.

A good idea would be to listen more. Ask your classmates about their interests and show interest in their answers.

Our advice is that you put your phone away at break time. Look up and say hello!

We think the best thing for you to do is to be the friend you want to have: loyal, honest and kind. Then you will maintain your friendships.

Your friends at the Problem Page

A grammar check

Before printing, Omar checked the letter. "Wait! Hassan wrote You should to call him."

"What's wrong?"

"After should, we use the base verb, without to. You should call him. Not should to call."

"You're right. Fixed!"

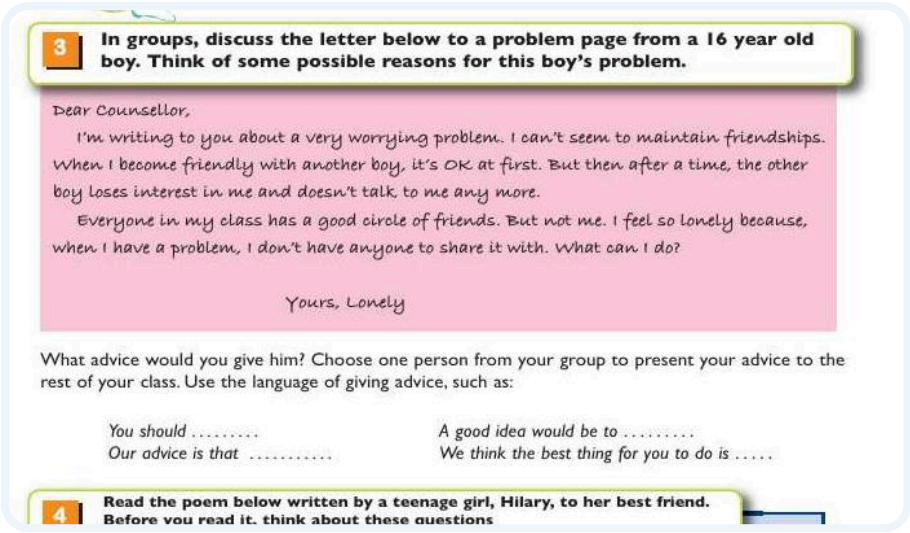
❁ ❁ ❁

Two weeks later, there was a new member in the science club. He was quiet at first, but he asked good questions and listened carefully.

At the end of the meeting, he said shyly, "I'm the boy who wrote the letter. Thank you."

Bader smiled. "Do you want to hang out with us after school? We're going to the library."

The boy smiled for the first time in weeks. Lonely was not lonely anymore.



3 **In groups, discuss the letter below to a problem page from a 16 year old boy. Think of some possible reasons for this boy's problem.**

Dear Counsellor,

I'm writing to you about a very worrying problem. I can't seem to maintain friendships. When I become friendly with another boy, it's OK at first. But then after a time, the other boy loses interest in me and doesn't talk to me any more.

Everyone in my class has a good circle of friends. But not me. I feel so lonely because, when I have a problem, I don't have anyone to share it with. What can I do?

Yours, Lonely

What advice would you give him? Choose one person from your group to present your advice to the rest of your class. Use the language of giving advice, such as:

You should ..... *A good idea would be to .....*
Our advice is that ..... *We think the best thing for you to do is .....*

4 **Read the poem below written by a teenage girl, Hilary, to her best friend. Before you read it, think about these questions**

A letter to a problem page

📖 Words from the story

loyal
مخلص

trustworthy
جدير بالثقة

circle of friends
دائرة الأصدقاء

lonely
وحيد

maintain
يحافظ على

hurtful
مؤذٍ

hang out
يقضي الوقت مع

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Friends are very important to teenagers
- ✔ Qualities of a good friend: loyal, honest, trustworthy, kind and helpful, a good listener
- ✔ Giving advice: You should ... / A good idea would be to ... / Our advice is that ... / We think the best thing for you to do is ...
- ✔ The problem letter: a 16-year-old boy can't maintain friendships, feels lonely and has no one to share problems with
- ✔ Advice: join clubs, be a good listener, show interest in others
- ✔ "should" + base verb: You should call him (not "should to call")

🤔 Little questions

1. Give an adjective for a good friend
   Answer: Loyal

2. How do you start advice?
   Answer: You should ...
3. What does "maintain" mean?
   Answer: Keep something going
4. Correct this: "You should to call him."
   Answer: You should call him.



Lesson 2-4 · Western Influence: Good or Bad?

The Mall Survey

An interview story · Theme 2: Those Teenage Things

👥 Ibrahim and Zayed, two students doing a survey in a Muscat shopping mall

For their English project, Ibrahim and Zayed had to do a survey: How does Western culture **influence** Omani teenagers? They took a notebook and went to a big shopping mall in Muscat.

Interview one: the food court

They stopped next to a **fast food outlet**. A boy was eating a burger.

"Excuse me," said Ibrahim. "Can I ask you some questions? **Do you think** fast food is popular with teenagers?"

"Yes, very popular."

"**Why do you think** it's popular?"

"Because it's quick and **convenient**. You get it in two minutes. Pizzas, burgers... it's easy."

"**Can you give me some examples** of Omani food you also like?"

The boy smiled. "Of course! My mother's shuwa at Eid is the best food in the world."

💡 Follow-up questions like "Why?" and "How do you mean?" help you get more information.

Interview two: the shoe shop

Next, they talked to a young man buying trainers.

"**What kind of** shoes do you like?" asked Zayed.

"**Fashionable** ones. Western brands."

"**How do you mean**, fashionable?"

"New styles. The ones famous players wear."

"**Can you tell me** if you also wear traditional clothes?"

"Every day! I wear the dishdasha to school and to the mosque. These shoes are for football only."

Interview three: an older man

Finally, they spoke to an old man sitting on a bench.

"Sir, do you think young people are changing?"

"Yes. There are **changing tastes**. When I was young, we didn't have shopping malls. We went to the souk. Now teenagers like Western fashions and fast food."

"Is that bad?"

The old man thought. "Not all of it. Some ideas from other cultures are useful. But we must keep our **traditions**: the khanjar, Omani dress, our traditional food, our good manners. Take useful ideas from other cultures, but carefully."

The results

Back at school, the boys wrote their results:

Eating: Teenagers like fast food outlets, pizzas and burgers, because they are quick and convenient. But fast food is not always healthy.

Shopping: They like shopping malls, fashionable shoes and Western fashions.

Traditions: They still wear Omani dress and love traditional food. The khanjar is still a proud symbol.

Good or bad?

In class, the teacher asked, "So, is Western influence good or bad?"

A student said, "All bad!" Another said, "All good!"

Ibrahim stood up. "Our survey shows it is not all good or all bad. We must discuss both sides. Some things are useful, some are not. The important thing is to keep our own culture."

The teacher nodded. "That's a balanced answer."

Question practice

At the end, the teacher wrote the question phrases from their interviews on the board:

Do you think ...? / Why do you think ...? / Can you give me some examples? / What kind of ...? / How do you mean? / Can you tell me ...?

"Now," she said, "ask your partner about clothes."

Zayed turned to Ibrahim with a smile. "What kind of clothes do you like? Why do you think they are popular?"

Ibrahim pointed to his dishdasha. "This kind. Because it's comfortable, it's beautiful, and it's ours."



Sound Bites: Asking Questions

📖 Words from the story

influence تأثير	**fast food outlet** مطعم وجبات سريعة
fashionable عصري	**tradition** تقليد
changing tastes أذواق متغيرة	**convenient** مريح / سهل

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Western culture influences what teenagers eat, wear and buy
- ✔ Eating: fast food outlets, pizzas and burgers are quick and convenient
- ✔ Shopping: shopping malls, fashionable shoes and Western fashions
- ✔ Keep Omani traditions: the khanjar, traditional food, Omani dress
- ✔ take useful ideas from other cultures carefully
- ✔ Asking questions: Do you think ...? Why do you think ...? Can you give me some examples? What kind of ...? How do you mean? Can you tell me ...?
- ✔ Don't think all Western influence is good or all is bad: discuss both sides

🤔 Little questions

1. Name an Omani tradition
   Answer: Wearing the khanjar

2. A question to get examples?

   Answer: Can you give me some examples?

3. "Convenient" means?

   Answer: Easy to get or use

4. Ask a partner about clothes

   Answer: What kind of clothes do you like?



Lesson 2-5 · Teenage Angst: Writing to a Problem Page

The Counsellor's Red Pen

A school story | Theme 2: Those Teenage Things

👥 Mr Khamis, the school counsellor, and three students who write to him: Nabil, Taha and Munira

Mr Khamis was the school **counsellor**. Every week, students put letters in the blue box outside his office. They wrote about their **angst**, their worries and fears.

This week there were three letters.

Letter one: Nabil

> Dear Mr Khamis, I have problems playing football with my friends. They never pass the ball to me, and they laugh when I miss. What can I do? Nabil

Mr Khamis wrote back: Hi there, Nabil! How are you? Practise a little every day, and talk to your friends calmly. A true friend will understand. Take care, speak soon.

Letter two: Taha

> Dear Mr Khamis, I am very worried about my schoolwork. I have too much homework and I feel a lot of **pressure**. I can't sleep. Taha

Mr Khamis wrote: Sorry I haven't replied before, Taha, but I wanted to think carefully. Make a timetable. Do a little homework every day, and rest well. Come and see me on Sunday. Look after yourself.

Letter three: Munira (from the girls' school next door)

The counsellor of the girls' school sent Mr Khamis a letter to share with the boys, as an example. Munira was **confused** about choosing a **career**:

> I like science and I like art. My parents want me to be a doctor. I don't know what to choose.

Her counsellor answered: Think about what you love and what you are good at. Talk to your parents openly. I can't wait to see you again next week to discuss it.

💡 Proofread = look for errors in your writing. Edit = correct the errors.

The red pen

The next day, Mr Khamis visited Grade 11. "Today you are going to write a letter to a problem page," he said. "But first, I'll teach you a secret weapon: the red pen."

He showed them a letter full of mistakes:

> Dear Sir, i have a problm with my freind. he dont talk to me

"First, we **proofread**: we look for errors in grammar and spelling. Then we **edit**: we correct them. We use a simple code." He wrote in red:

> Sp = spelling (problm → problem, freind → friend)
>
> Gr = grammar (he dont → he doesn't)
>
> P = punctuation (i → I, and a full stop at the end)

"And one more problem," he said. "This letter is to a friend, so don't write Dear Sir. Use an informal opening like Hi or Dear Ali."

Opening and closing

"Informal letters have special phrases," Mr Khamis continued. "For the beginning: Hi there! How are you? Sorry I haven't replied before, but... For the end: Take care, speak soon. Look after yourself. I can't wait to see you again."

"Teacher," asked a boy, "Look after yourself — beginning or end?"

"End of the letter. Good question!"

Writing time

The boys wrote their letters. Mr Khamis walked around the class. "Remember: always leave time at the end to proofread your writing."

Nabil (yes, the same Nabil) finished early. He read his letter again and found two spelling mistakes. He corrected them with a red pen.

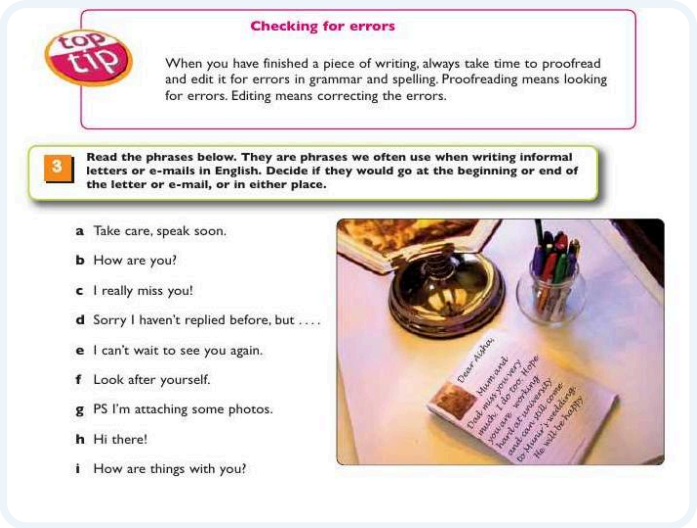
"See?" said Mr Khamis. "You're your own editor now."

❁ ❁ ❁

That week, Nabil's friends passed him the ball. Taha slept well with his new timetable. And Mr Khamis's blue box had a new letter:

> Dear Mr Khamis, Thank you! Take care, speak soon. Nabil and Taha

There were no mistakes in it.



Checking for errors

top tip

When you have finished a piece of writing, always take time to proofread and edit it for errors in grammar and spelling. Proofreading means looking for errors. Editing means correcting the errors.

3 **Read the phrases below. They are phrases we often use when writing informal letters or e-mails in English. Decide if they would go at the beginning or end of the letter or e-mail, or in either place.**

a Take care, speak soon.
b How are you?
c I really miss you!
d Sorry I haven't replied before, but ....
e I can't wait to see you again.
f Look after yourself.
g PS I'm attaching some photos.
h Hi there!
i How are things with you?

Top tip: Checking for errors and informal phrases

📖 Words from the story

angst
قلق

proofread
يدقق الكتابة

edit
يحرر / يصحح

counsellor
مرشد

pressure
ضغط

career
مهنة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Teenagers write to a problem page for advice
- ✔ The three letters: Nabil had problems playing football with friends, Taha was worried about schoolwork, Munira was confused about choosing a career
- ✔ Proofread: look for errors in grammar and spelling
- ✔ edit: correct them
- ✔ Correction code: Sp = spelling, Gr = grammar, P = punctuation
- ✔ Informal beginnings: Hi there! / How are you? / Sorry I haven't replied before, but ...
- ✔ Informal endings: Take care, speak soon. / Look after yourself. / I can't wait to see you again.
- ✔ Don't write "Dear Sir" to a friend, and always leave time to proofread

🤔 Little questions

1. What does "proofread" mean?
   Answer: Look for errors in writing

2. One opening phrase

   Answer: How are you?

3. What was Taha worried about?

   Answer: His schoolwork

4. Beginning or end? "Look after yourself."

   Answer: End of the letter



Lesson 2-6 · Across Cultures: The USA + Joan of Arc

The Museum Night

An adventure story Theme 2: Those Teenage Things

👥 Hassan and his cousin Waleed, visiting a history museum with Waleed's father

Hassan's uncle worked in Washington for one year, and in the summer Hassan visited him. On the first day, his cousin Waleed said, "Welcome to the **capital** of the USA!"

"I thought the capital was New York," said Hassan.

"Many people think that. No! The capital of the United States of America is **Washington, D.C.**"

Fact file

In the evening, they visited a big museum. Waleed's father read the fact file at the entrance:

> The United States has **50 states**. Population: about **308 million**. Currency: the **US dollar**. **Independence** Day: **4 July** (**1776**).

"Independence Day is the day the country became free," he explained. "Many Americans are the children of **immigrants**: people who came from other countries to live here."

The science hall

In the science hall, there was an old telephone behind glass.

"In **1876**, **Alexander Graham Bell** got a **patent** for the telephone," read Waleed. "A patent is an official paper. It says: this invention is yours."

Next to it was a glowing light bulb. "**Thomas Edison**, the light bulb," said Hassan.

And at the end of the hall, there was a big photo of an astronaut on the moon. "**1969**," read Waleed's father. "The first people on the moon."

A teenage heroine

In the history hall, there was a special exhibition about Europe. Hassan stopped in front of a painting of a young woman in armour.

"Who is she?"

Waleed's father read the board. "This is **Joan of Arc**. She was a French peasant girl, born in **1412**. Her country was at war. At just **seventeen**, she led the French army."

"Seventeen? That's almost my age!"

"Yes. The English army had a **siege** around the city of **Orléans**. A siege is when an army surrounds a city and stops food and help from going in. Joan and the French soldiers freed Orléans."

> 💡 Joan of Arc led the French army at seventeen, freed Orléans and became a national heroine of France.

"What happened to her?"

"Later she was captured. There was a **trial**, a court case, and she died in **1431**. She was only nineteen. Today she is a national **heroine** of France. A heroine is a woman who is admired for her courage."

Hassan was quiet. "A teenager who changed things," he said.

Comparing with Oman

On the way home, Waleed asked, "How do people travel in America?"

"By car, by plane, by train," said his father. "The country is huge."

"And in Oman?" asked Hassan. Then he answered his own question. "By car on the highways, by plane to Salalah and Khasab, by ferry to Musandam and Masirah, and by bus between cities."

"Good comparison!" said his uncle.

❁ ❁ ❁

That night, Hassan wrote in his diary: Today I learned that the capital of the USA is Washington, D.C., not New York. Bell got the telephone patent in 1876. And Joan of Arc was a teenager who freed Orléans. Age is not a reason to do nothing.



Cultures

United States of America

Official name:	The United States of America
Location:	North America, between the Pacific and Atlantic Oceans
Capital:	Washington, D.C.
Population:	308,000,000
Area:	9,631,418 km^2 (50 states and district of Columbia)
Languages:	English, Spanish, other Indo-European and Asian and Pacific languages
Currency:	US dollar

The United States of America is the third or fourth largest country in the world by area (after Canada

American tribes known as American Indians. In the early 16th century, immigrants started arriving from

Across Cultures: USA fact file

📖 Words from the story

independence استقلال	**immigrant** مهاجر
patent براءة اختراع	**siege** حصار
heroine بطلة	**trial** محاكمة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The USA has 50 states
- ✔ its capital is Washington, D.C. (not New York)
- ✔ Population about 308 million
- ✔ currency: US dollar
- ✔ Independence Day: 4 July 1776
- ✔ Alexander Graham Bell got the patent for the telephone in 1876
- ✔ Thomas Edison: the light bulb
- ✔ 1969: first people on the moon
- ✔ Joan of Arc (1412-1431) was a French peasant girl who led the French army at seventeen
- ✔ She freed the city of Orléans and is now a national heroine of France
- ✔ Compare with Oman: people travel by car, plane, ferry and bus

🤔 Little questions

1. Capital of the USA?

   Answer: Washington, D.C.

2. Who got the patent for the telephone?
   Answer: Alexander Graham Bell
3. Which city did Joan free?
   Answer: Orléans
4. When is Independence Day in the USA?
   Answer: 4 July (1776)



Lesson 3-1 · Types of Tourism

The Tour Operator's First Day

A workplace story Theme 3: Travellers and Tourists

👥 Saleh, a young man on his first day at a Muscat travel agency, and his manager Mr Badr

Saleh was nervous. It was his first day at Oman Horizons, a **tour operator** in Muscat: a company that plans and sells holidays.

His manager, Mr Badr, gave him a pile of papers. "Before you talk to customers, you must know our holidays. Let's start."

Types of holidays

Mr Badr pointed to the posters on the wall.

"A **safari holiday**: to see wild animals in Africa. A **sightseeing tour**: to visit famous places in a city. A **camping trip**: sleeping in tents, like in Wahiba Sands. An **adventure holiday**: climbing, caving, diving. A **cruise**: a holiday on a big ship. A **history tour**: forts, museums, old towns. And a **sailing holiday** on a boat."

Types of tourism

"Now the bigger groups," said Mr Badr. "We call them types of tourism."

He wrote on the board:

Wildlife holidays: going on safari, whale watching

Cultural tourism: museums, local festivals

Extreme sports: bungee jumping, white water rafting

Sailing holidays: luxury yacht hire

"Quick test," he said. "A customer wants museums and theatres. Which type?"

"Cultural tourism," said Saleh.

"Correct!"

💡 In matching tasks, look for key words first.

The customers

At ten o'clock, the first customers arrived: a family from Germany.

"We want a quiet beach," said the father. "No people, no noise."

Saleh looked at his papers. "We have a **secluded** beach near Ras Al Jinz. It's quiet and private. The sea is **stunning**, and the area is **unspoilt**: nobody has built hotels there."

The family smiled. "Perfect."

Next came two young men from Spain. "We want something **thrilling**!"

"Then an adventure holiday," said Saleh. "Canyoning in Wadi Shab, and caving in Majlis Al Jinn!"

Then an older couple. "We want something **luxurious**."

"A five-star cruise along the coast of Musandam, with comfortable rooms and excellent food."

Finally a student from Japan. "I love cities with people from everywhere."

"Muscat and Dubai are **cosmopolitan** cities, with many cultures. And for something **exotic**, unusual and exciting, visit the old souk of Muttrah."

Tourists and travellers

At lunch, Saleh asked, "Is a tourist the same as a traveller?"

"Not always," said Mr Badr. "A traveller explores freely, without a fixed plan. A tourist often follows a planned tour, like the ones we sell."

Good and bad

In the afternoon, an old man from Sur came in. He was not a customer.

"I want to ask you something," he said. "Tourism brings many visitors to our town. Is it good for us?"

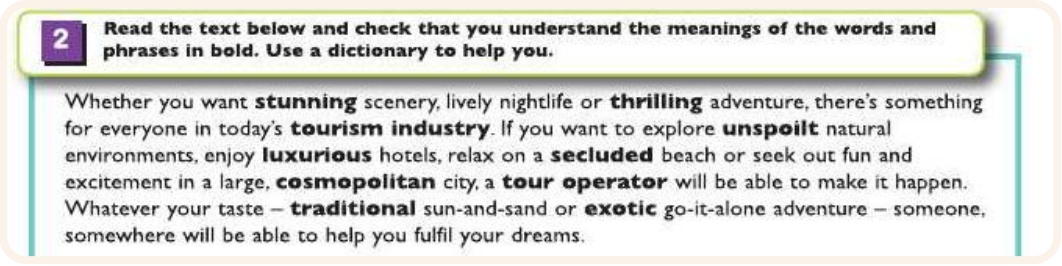
Mr Badr answered honestly. "There are benefits: jobs for young people, money for the economy, and awareness of other cultures. But there can be problems too: changes to traditions and to ways of thinking. That's why we ask visitors to respect our culture: modest dress, and respect for the mosques."

The old man nodded. "Then welcome to them."

End of the day

At five o'clock, Mr Badr said, "Today I saw you skimming the papers for the general idea, and scanning them for a quick answer, like a name or a price. That is a good skill."

Saleh smiled. "I didn't even know I was doing it."



2 **Read the text below and check that you understand the meanings of the words and phrases in bold. Use a dictionary to help you.**

Whether you want **stunning** scenery, lively nightlife or **thrilling** adventure, there's something for everyone in today's **tourism industry**. If you want to explore **unspoilt** natural environments, enjoy **luxurious** hotels, relax on a **secluded** beach or seek out fun and excitement in a large, **cosmopolitan** city, a **tour operator** will be able to make it happen. Whatever your taste – **traditional** sun-and-sand or **exotic** go-it-alone adventure – someone, somewhere will be able to help you fulfil your dreams.

Holiday vocabulary text

📖 Words from the story

stunning مذهل	**thrilling** مثير
unspoilt بِكر لم يُفسد	**luxurious** فاخر
secluded منعزل	**cosmopolitan** متعدد الثقافات
tour operator منظم رحلات	**exotic** غريب ساحر

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Types of holidays: safari, sightseeing tour, camping trip, adventure holiday, cruise, history tour, sailing holiday
- ✔ Types of tourism: wildlife (safari, whale watching), cultural (museums, local festivals), extreme sports (bungee jumping, white water rafting), sailing (luxury yacht hire)
- ✔ Benefits for local people: jobs, money for the economy, awareness of other cultures
- ✔ Problems: changes to traditions and ways of thinking
- ✔ A traveller explores freely
- ✔ a tourist often follows a planned tour
- ✔ Skim for the main idea, scan for specific information
- ✔ in matching tasks, look for key words first

🤔 Little questions

1. What is a "secluded" beach?
   Answer: A quiet, private beach
2. Name an extreme sport
   Answer: Bungee jumping
3. One benefit of tourism
   Answer: Jobs

4. Which type of tourism is "museums and theatres"?

Answer: Cultural tourism



Lesson 3-2 · Getting There + Expressing the Future

The Road to Salalah

A road-trip story Theme 3: Travellers and Tourists

👥 Ahmed and his cousin Sami, who travel from Dubai to Salalah for the Khareef

Ahmed lived in Dubai, and his cousin Sami lived in Salalah. In July, Sami called him.

"The Khareef is starting! Are you coming?"

"Yes! I'**m going to** visit you this summer. I decided last week."

💡 going to = a plan you already made. will = a decision you make now, a promise or a prediction.

Bus or plane?

"How are you going to travel?" asked Sami.

"I don't know. Bus or plane?"

"The plane is a two-hour flight over the Hajar Mountains and the Empty Quarter. The bus is long, but you see everything."

Ahmed thought for a second. "OK, **I'll take** the bus!" (He decided right now.)

"Great. And don't worry, **I'll meet** you at the bus station," said Sami. (A promise.)

The ticket

At the bus station in Dubai, the man at the window gave Ahmed his ticket and his **itinerary**, the plan of the trip.

"The bus **leaves** at seven a.m. tomorrow," he said. "You'**re crossing** the **border** at Al Ain and Buraimi, so bring your **passport** for the **formalities**."

Ahmed called his mother. "I'**m leaving** tomorrow at seven. Everything is arranged." (A fixed arrangement: present continuous.)

The journey

The bus left Dubai early in the morning. At the border, everybody showed their passports. Then the bus drove on to **Nizwa**, with its old fort and palm trees. There was a short **refreshment** stop for tea and dates.

"Look at those clouds over the mountains," said an old man next to Ahmed. "It'**s going to** rain."

Ahmed smiled. His English teacher used this example: when we can see evidence now, we use going to for a prediction.

After Nizwa, the road went south through the desert: **Haima**, then **Thumrait**. It was hot and empty. Ahmed fell asleep.

A conversation about the future

When he woke up, the old man was reading a newspaper. "Do you think people will still travel by bus in fifty years?" he asked.

"Perhaps people **won't** need buses," said Ahmed. "Perhaps there **will** be flying cars!"

"And perhaps people **won't** send letters anymore," laughed the old man. "Oh, they don't already!"

(Predictions about the future: will.)

Salalah

Late in the evening, the bus went down from the mountains. Suddenly, everything was green, and a cool mist covered the hills. Salalah!

Sami was waiting at the station, as he promised. Next to him was a smart man in a uniform.

"Who is that?"

"My father's **chauffeur**, his private driver. **I'll help** you with your bag," said Sami. (An offer.)

"Thanks. So what's the plan?"

"Tomorrow we'**re meeting** my brother at Wadi Darbat at ten. It's all arranged. And on Friday we'**re going to** visit Mughsayl. I'll show you everything."

Ahmed's notebook

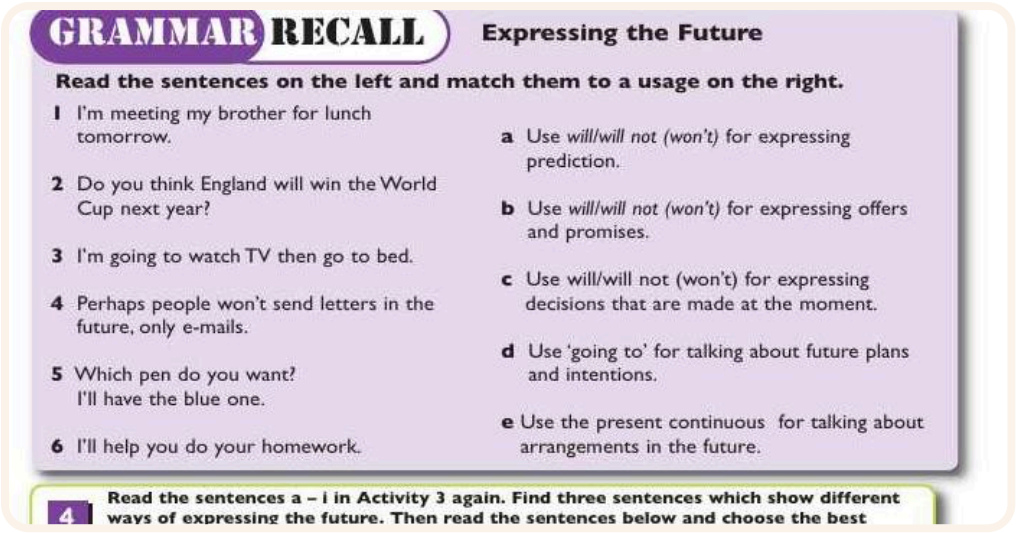
That night Ahmed wrote the rules in his notebook:

will: predictions, offers, promises, decisions made now (I'll have the blue one.)

going to: plans and intentions (I'm going to watch TV.), and predictions from evidence

present continuous: fixed arrangements (I'm meeting my brother tomorrow.)

And a mistake to avoid: I will meet my friend tomorrow at 5, we arranged it → better: I'm meeting my friend tomorrow at 5.



GRAMMAR RECALL — Expressing the Future

Read the sentences on the left and match them to a usage on the right.

1 I'm meeting my brother for lunch tomorrow.

2 Do you think England will win the World Cup next year?

3 I'm going to watch TV then go to bed.

4 Perhaps people won't send letters in the future, only e-mails.

5 Which pen do you want? I'll have the blue one.

6 I'll help you do your homework.

a Use *will/will not (won't)* for expressing prediction.

b Use *will/will not (won't)* for expressing offers and promises.

c Use will/will not (won't) for expressing decisions that are made at the moment.

d Use 'going to' for talking about future plans and intentions.

e Use the present continuous for talking about arrangements in the future.

4 Read the sentences a – i in Activity 3 again. Find three sentences which show different ways of expressing the future. Then read the sentences below and choose the best

Grammar Recall: Expressing the Future

📖 Words from the story

border حدود	**passport** جواز سفر
formalities إجراءات	**chauffeur** سائق خاص
itinerary برنامج الرحلة	**refreshment** استراحة / مرطبات

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ The trip from Dubai to Salalah: by bus through Al Ain / Buraimi, Nizwa, Haima and Thumrait, or a two-hour flight over the Hajar Mountains and the Empty Quarter
- ✔ will: predictions (Perhaps people won't send letters.)
- ✔ will: offers and promises (I'll help you.) and decisions made now (I'll have the blue one.)
- ✔ going to: plans and intentions (I'm going to watch TV.) and predictions from evidence (Look at those clouds! It's going to rain.)
- ✔ present continuous: fixed arrangements (I'm meeting my brother tomorrow.)
- ✔ Instant decision → will
- ✔ plan already made → going to
- ✔ fixed arrangement → present continuous

🤔 Little questions

1. Which form for a promise?
   Answer: will

2. Which form for a plan?

   Answer: going to

3. Which form for an arrangement?

   Answer: Present continuous

4. Choose: Look at those clouds! It (will / is going to) rain.

   Answer: is going to



Lesson 3-3 · Destinations

The Brochure Competition

A competition story | Theme 3: Travellers and Tourists

👥 Two teams in a class competition, "Team Falcon" (Mazin and Rashid) and "Team Dhow" (Anwar and Jamal), and their teacher Mr Hamed

Mr Hamed held up a colourful holiday brochure. "Why do people read this and say I want to go there?"

"Because of the pictures?" said Mazin.

"Partly. But also because of the words. **Holiday brochures** use **persuasive adjectives** to attract visitors. Today you're going to make a brochure about Oman. The best brochure wins!"

The adjective bank

First, Mr Hamed wrote an "adjective bank" on the board, in four groups:

For hotels: **five-star**, first-class, luxurious

For cities: lively, **vibrant**, cosmopolitan, entertaining

For quiet places: secluded, private, **dreamy**, romantic

For unusual places: exotic, **rare**, unspoilt, adventurous

"And one more: **superb** means excellent, very, very good."

Learn phrases, not words

"Here's a secret," said Mr Hamed. "Don't learn single words. Learn **phrases**. Not just busy, but busy souks. Phrases are easier to remember and easier to use."

He wrote a list of phrases for Oman:

rolling sand dunes, old forts, traditional handicrafts, **busy souks**, beautiful beaches, **wooden dhows**, high mountains

💡 Learn words in phrases: "busy souks", not just "busy".

Team Falcon's brochure

Mazin and Rashid wrote about the desert and Nizwa:

Discover the **rolling sand dunes** of Wahiba Sands! Sleep under the stars in an **unspoilt** desert. Then visit Nizwa, a city of **old forts** and **traditional handicrafts**. Enjoy a **superb** dinner of Omani food. An **adventurous** trip you will never forget!

Team Dhow's brochure

Anwar and Jamal wrote about the coast:

Come to Muscat, a **vibrant** and **cosmopolitan** city! Walk through the **busy souks** of Muttrah, and sail on **wooden dhows** at sunset. Stay in a **five-star** hotel on a **secluded** beach. And in Musandam, see **rare** dolphins in **dreamy** blue water.

A small mistake

Mr Hamed read Team Dhow's first version. "Wait. You wrote a five-stars hotel."

"Is it wrong?" asked Jamal.

"Yes. When five-star is an adjective before a noun, there's no -s. A five-star hotel, a ten-year-old boy."

"Fixed!"

Role-play: choosing a hotel

Before the result, the teams did a role-play. Anwar was a hotel receptionist, and Rashid was a tourist.

"Good morning. Can I help you?"

"Yes, I'm looking for a hotel. Is your hotel lively?"

"Our hotel is quiet and secluded, with a private beach. But there's a five-star hotel in the city centre. It's very vibrant."

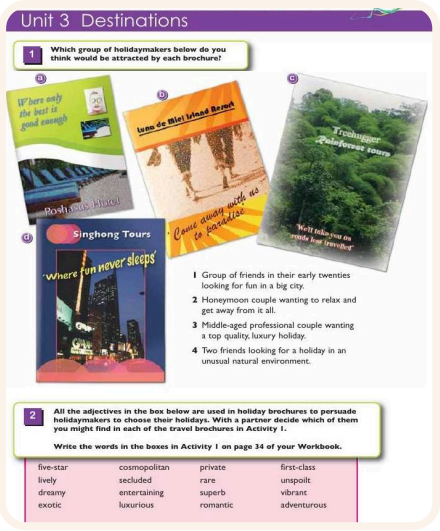
"Hmm, I'd like something quiet. I'll stay here, please."

The winner

Mr Hamed read both brochures again. "It's very difficult. Both teams used persuasive adjectives and phrases. But I'll ask one question: what does rare mean?"

"Not common!" shouted Mazin and Anwar together.

Mr Hamed laughed. "Then it's rare to have two winners, but today we do. Both brochures go on the school wall."


Unit 3 Destinations

1 Which group of holidaymakers below do you think would be attracted by each brochure?

a Where only the best is good enough — Posh Hotel

b Luna de Miel Island Resort — Come away with us to paradise

c Treetopper Rainforest tours — We'll take you to remote, lost treetops!

d Singhong Tours — Where fun never sleeps

1 Group of friends in their early twenties looking for fun in a big city.
2 Honeymoon couple wanting to relax and get away from it all.
3 Middle-aged professional couple wanting a top quality, luxury holiday.
4 Two friends looking for a holiday in an unusual natural environment.

2 All the adjectives in the box below are used in holiday brochures to persuade holidaymakers to choose their holidays. With a partner decide which of them you might find in each of the travel brochures in Activity 1.

Write the words in the boxes in Activity 1 on page 34 of your Workbook.

five-star	cosmopolitan	private	first-class
lively	secluded	rare	unspoilt
dreamy	entertaining	superb	vibrant
exotic	luxurious	romantic	adventurous

Holiday brochures and adjectives

📖 Words from the story

five-star
خمس نجوم

vibrant
نابض بالحياة

superb
ممتاز

rare
نادر

dreamy
حالم

rolling sand dunes
كثبان رملية متموجة

busy souks
أسواق مزدحمة

wooden dhows
سفن خشبية تقليدية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Holiday brochures use persuasive adjectives to attract visitors
- ✔ Hotels: five-star, first-class, luxurious
- ✔ cities: lively, vibrant, cosmopolitan, entertaining
- ✔ Quiet places: secluded, private, dreamy, romantic
- ✔ unusual places: exotic, rare, unspoilt, adventurous
- ✔ Phrases for Oman: rolling sand dunes, old forts, traditional handicrafts, busy souks, beautiful beaches, wooden dhows, high mountains
- ✔ Learn words in phrases, not single words
- ✔ Say "a five-star hotel", not "a five-stars hotel"

🤔 Little questions

1. Adjective for a lively city?
   Answer: Vibrant
2. Phrase for Nizwa?
   Answer: Old forts
3. What does "rare" mean?
   Answer: Not common
4. Describe Wahiba Sands with two phrases
   Answer: Rolling sand dunes and unspoilt desert



Lesson 3-4 · Tourist Information: Dhofar

The Information Desk

A role-play story Theme 3: Travellers and Tourists

👥 Fahad, a student volunteer at the Salalah tourist information centre during the Khareef

In the summer holiday, Fahad worked as a volunteer at the tourist information centre in Salalah. It was the **Khareef**, the rainy season, and visitors came from everywhere.

His supervisor, Mr Said, gave him a map. "Learn these places. And learn how to make suggestions politely."

Visitor one: the bird lover

A man with binoculars came in. "I love birds. Where should I go?"

"**Why don't you visit** Tawi Attair?" said Fahad. "Its name means the Well of Birds. It's a natural **sinkhole**, a huge hole in the ground, over **100 metres wide** and **220 metres deep**. It's home to many species of birds."

"Wonderful! I'll go tomorrow."

Visitor two: the history teacher

Next was a teacher from Kuwait. "I'm interested in history."

"**May I suggest that** you visit Al Balid? It's an **archaeological** site, a city from the **10th century CE**, with the remains of an old mosque."

"Anything else?"

"**You might like to** see Khor Rori. The ancient town there is called **Sumhuram**. It had strong walls, and it was on the **Incense Trail**, the old road of the frankincense trade. There are **excavations** there: archaeologists dig to find old things."

"And where can I see what they found?"

"**If I were you, I'd** visit the Salalah Museum. It has **artefacts**, objects made by people long ago, from the archaeological sites."

💡 Making suggestions: May I suggest that ...? / Why don't you ...? / How about + verb-ing? / You might like to ... / If I were you, I'd ...

Visitor three: a family

A father came in with his two sons. "We want something for the children."

"**How about taking** them to Wadi Darbat? There are waterfalls and lakes, and it's green in the Khareef."

"Hmm," said the father. "**I'd prefer to** go to the beach."

"Then **how about visiting** Mughsayl? It has beautiful beaches and **blowholes**: holes in the rocks where the sea shoots water high into the air."

"The boys will love that! But **I'd rather go on Thursday**, when it's less crowded."

"Good idea."

A mistake

Later, Fahad heard a new volunteer say to a tourist, "How about visit the fort?"

Fahad whispered, "After how about, use verb **-ing**. How about visiting the fort?"

Visitor four: the diver

At the end of the day, a young man came in. "Mughsayl, Wadi Darbat... I've seen them all."

"Then **let's** think," said Fahad. "**You might like to** go diving instead."

The man laughed. "**Let's go diving instead!** That's what I wanted to hear. **Good idea.**"

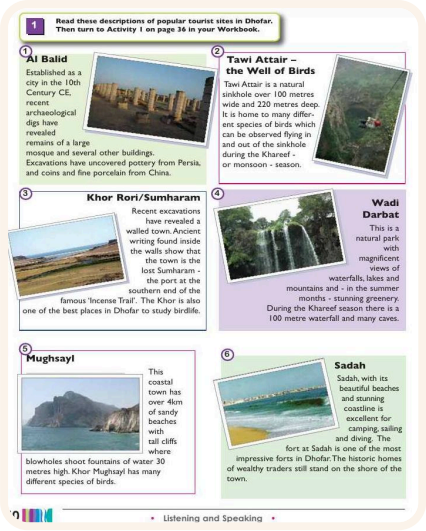
Responding to suggestions

That evening, Mr Said asked Fahad, "What did you learn today?"

"How to make suggestions, and how people respond. They say Good idea, or they give another idea politely: I'd prefer to go to the wadi, I'd rather go on Thursday, Let's go diving instead."

Mr Said nodded. "And Dhofar?"

Fahad smiled and counted on his fingers. "Al Balid, Tawi Attair, Khor Rori, Wadi Darbat, Mughsayl and the Salalah Museum."



Popular tourist sites in Dhofar

📖 Words from the story

archaeological أثري	**sinkhole** حفرة طبيعية عميقة
excavation تنقيب	**Khareef** موسم الخريف
blowhole فتحة نفث	**artefact** قطعة أثرية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Al Balid: a city from the 10th century CE with old mosque remains
- ✔ Tawi Attair, "the Well of Birds": a natural sinkhole over 100 m wide and 220 m deep
- ✔ Khor Rori / Sumhuram: an ancient walled town on the Incense Trail
- ✔ Wadi Darbat: waterfalls and lakes, green in the Khareef
- ✔ Mughsayl: beaches and blowholes
- ✔ Salalah Museum: artefacts
- ✔ Making suggestions: May I suggest that ...? Why don't you visit ...? How about taking them to ...? You might like to ... If I were you, I'd ...
- ✔ Responding: Good idea. / I'd prefer to ... / I'd rather go on Thursday. / Let's go diving instead.
- ✔ "How about" + verb-ing: How about visiting the museum?

🤔 Little questions

1. What is Tawi Attair also called?
   Answer: The Well of Birds

2. When is Wadi Darbat green?
   Answer: In the Khareef
3. Respond politely with another idea
   Answer: I'd prefer to ...
4. Correct this: "How about visit the fort?"
   Answer: How about visiting the fort?



Lesson 3-5 · Designing a Tour

The Nizwa Morning

A planning story Theme 3: Travellers and Tourists

👥 Brothers Hilal and Humaid, who design a tour for their visiting friend Yusuf from Istanbul

Hilal's friend Yusuf lived in Istanbul. Last year, Hilal visited him, and Yusuf gave him a walking tour of the old part of the city, Sultanahmet. Now Yusuf was coming to Oman.

"We must give him a tour as good as his," said Hilal to his brother Humaid.

Studying a tour description

Hilal still had the paper Yusuf gave him in Istanbul. They read it together:

> Our tour **starts at 9 a.m.** at the Blue Mosque. **First**, we will look at its beautiful tiles. **Then** we will **stroll** through the park to the old palace, which is **within walking distance**. **After that**, we will **wander** through the Grand Bazaar. **Finally**, we will have lunch with a view of the sea.

"Look," said Humaid. "It's well organised. It starts with a time and a place. It uses sequence words: first, then, after that, finally. It describes each place briefly. And it finishes with lunch."

💡 A good tour: start with a time and place, use sequence words, describe each place briefly, finish with lunch or shopping.

Planning their tour

"Step one," said Hilal. "Choose a town or region."

"Nizwa! It's very **historical**."

"Step two: decide the time. One morning, one day or one week?"

"One morning. He leaves for Salalah in the afternoon."

"Step three: list the places in order. Step four: add transport, meals and activities."

The first draft

Humaid wrote quickly:

> Nizwa Souk, lunch, Nizwa Fort, the goat market, Falaj Daris.

Hilal frowned. "This is just a list. And the order is wrong. The goat market is only early on Friday morning! And lunch can't be in the middle. Put the places in the order of the visit."

The final itinerary

They worked for an hour. Then they read their **itinerary**, their plan of places to visit:

A Morning in Nizwa

Our tour **starts at 8 a.m.** at the goat market, where farmers buy and sell animals every Friday.

Then we will **stroll** through Nizwa Souk, which **contains** shops of silver, pottery and traditional handicrafts.

After that, we will climb Nizwa Fort. It is **within walking distance** of the souk, so we will walk. From the top of its round tower, we will see the whole city and the palm gardens.

Next, we will drive ten minutes to Falaj Daris and **wander** along the old water channel.

Finally, we will have lunch at a traditional Omani restaurant: shuwa and halwa!

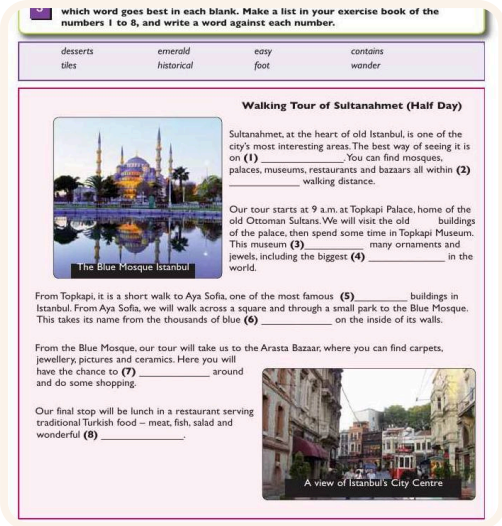
"Perfect," said Humaid. "Clear times, sequence words, and the right order."

The real tour

On Friday, Yusuf arrived. The brothers followed their itinerary exactly. At the goat market Yusuf laughed at the noise. In the souk he bought a silver khanjar for his father. On the tower of the fort he took a hundred photos.

At lunch, he said, "Your tour was better than mine!"

"No," said Hilal. "We learned from yours."



which word goes best in each blank. Make a list in your exercise book of the numbers 1 to 8, and write a word against each number.

desserts	*emerald*	*easy*	*contains*
tiles	*historical*	*foot*	*wander*

Walking Tour of Sultanahmet (Half Day)

The Blue Mosque Istanbul

Sultanahmet, at the heart of old Istanbul, is one of the city's most interesting areas. The best way of seeing it is on **(1)** _____. You can find mosques, palaces, museums, restaurants and bazaars all within **(2)** _____ walking distance.

Our tour starts at 9 a.m. at Topkapi Palace, home of the old Ottoman Sultans. We will visit the old buildings of the palace, then spend some time in Topkapi Museum. This museum **(3)** _____ many ornaments and jewels, including the biggest **(4)** _____ in the world.

From Topkapi, it is a short walk to Aya Sofia, one of the most famous **(5)**_____ buildings in Istanbul. From Aya Sofia, we will walk across a square and through a small park to the Blue Mosque. This takes its name from the thousands of blue **(6)** _____ on the inside of its walls.

From the Blue Mosque, our tour will take us to the Arasta Bazaar, where you can find carpets, jewellery, pictures and ceramics. Here you will have the chance to **(7)** _____ around and do some shopping.

Our final stop will be lunch in a restaurant serving traditional Turkish food – meat, fish, salad and wonderful **(8)** _____.

A view of Istanbul's City Centre

Walking Tour of Sultanahmet

📖 Words from the story

itinerary
برنامج الرحلة

stroll
يتنزه

wander
يتجول

historical
تاريخي

contain
يحتوي

within walking distance
على مسافة قريبة سيرًا

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ A tour description starts with a time and a place: "Our tour starts at 9 a.m. at ..."
- ✔ Sequence words: first, then, after that, finally
- ✔ Describe each place briefly and finish with lunch or shopping
- ✔ Planning a tour of Oman: choose a town or region, decide the time, list the places in order, add transport, meals and activities
- ✔ Use time expressions and sequence words to make the plan clear
- ✔ Don't list places without order: put them in the order of the visit

🤔 Little questions

1. What is an itinerary?
   Answer: A plan of places to visit
2. Give a sequence word
   Answer: After that
3. "Stroll" means?
   Answer: Walk in a slow relaxed way

4. Start an itinerary for Nizwa

Answer: Our tour starts at 8 a.m. at Nizwa Fort.



Lesson 3-6 · Reading for Pleasure: Omani Sailing Heroes

Two Ships, One Sea

A grandfather's story Theme 3: Travellers and Tourists

👥 Grandfather Juma, a retired sailor from Sur, and his grandson Ali on Muttrah Corniche

Ali and his grandfather Juma sat on the Corniche in Muttrah, looking at the boats.

"Grandfather, were you a sailor?"

"Yes. We Omanis are people of the sea. Let me tell you about two great **voyages**, two long journeys by sea. One I saw with my own eyes, and one I watched on television from this very place."

The first ship: Sohar

"In **1980**," said Grandfather, "a British man called **Tim Severin** came to Sur. He wanted to build a **replica** of a ninth-century Omani dhow."

"A replica?"

"An exact copy. He wanted to sail from Oman to China, like Sindbad in the old stories. He wanted to show that Sindbad's voyage was possible, and that Arabs had a great seafaring history."

"Did you help?"

Grandfather smiled. "I carried wood. There were no nails in the ship. The builders sewed the planks together with rope, the old way. They named the ship Sohar."

"And the **crew**, the people who worked on the ship?"

"Omanis and others. They didn't use modern machines to find their way. They used the stars and the **kamal**, a small wooden tool with a string, to navigate. They sailed from **Sur** across the ocean and reached **Guangzhou** in China on **6 June 1981**."

💡 When you read for pleasure, enjoy the story and don't stop for every new word.

The second ship: Musandam

"And the second voyage?" asked Ali.

"That was many years later. In **2009**, a young Omani called **Mohsin Al Busaidi** sailed **non-stop around the world**, without stopping at any port. He was the first Arab to do it."

"Alone?"

"No! Many people think that, but he sailed with four other crew members, five people in all. Their boat was a **trimaran**, a fast boat with three hulls, and its name was Musandam."

"When did they leave?"

"They left Muscat on **8 January 2009**. They crossed the **Equator**, the imaginary line around the middle of the Earth, and sailed through storms and huge waves in the southern oceans. They returned on **25 March 2009**, after **76 days**."

"And you were here?"

"Right here! Thousands of people welcomed them at Muttrah Corniche. I was one of them, waving the Omani flag."

Across cultures

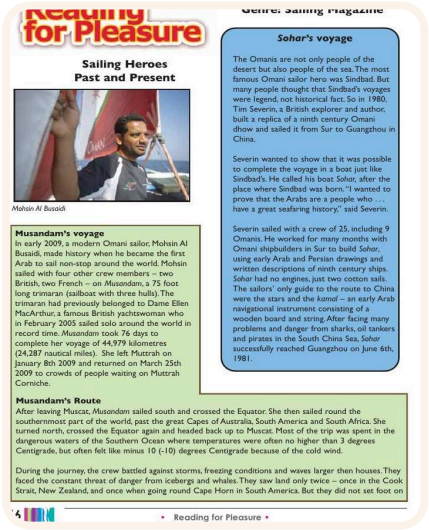
Ali thought for a moment. "My teacher told us about New Zealand. They are sea people too."

"Yes," said Grandfather. "Many peoples of the world love the sea. But never forget your own heroes."

❁ ❁ ❁

On the way home, Ali counted the facts on his fingers: "Sohar: 1980, Tim Severin, a replica, from Sur to Guangzhou, the stars and the kamal, 6 June 1981. Musandam: Mohsin Al Busaidi, a crew of five, a trimaran, 8 January to 25 March 2009, 76 days, non-stop."

Grandfather laughed. "You'll be a sailor yet."


Reading for Pleasure

Sailing Heroes Past and Present

Sohar's voyage

The Omanis are not only people of the desert but also people of the sea. The most famous Omani sailor hero was Sindbad. But many people thought that Sindbad's voyages were legend, not historical fact. So in 1980, Tim Severin, a British explorer and author, built a replica of a ninth century Omani dhow and sailed it from Sur to Guangzhou in China.

Severin wanted to show that it was possible to complete the voyage in a boat just like Sindbad's. He called his boat *Sohar*, after the place where Sindbad was born. "I wanted to prove that the Arabs are a people who ... have a great seafaring history," said Severin.

Severin sailed with a crew of 25, including 9 Omanis. He worked for many months with Omani shipbuilders in Sur to build *Sohar*, using early Arab and Persian drawings and written descriptions of ninth century ships. *Sohar* had no engines, just two cotton sails. The sailors' only guide to the route to China were the stars and the *kamal* – an early Arab navigational instrument consisting of a wooden board and string. After facing many problems and danger from sharks, oil tankers and pirates in the South China Sea, *Sohar* successfully reached Guangzhou on June 6th, 1981.

Sailing Heroes Past and Present

Mohsin Al Busaidi

Musandam's voyage

In early 2009, a modern Omani sailor, Mohsin Al Busaidi, made history when he became the first Arab to sail non-stop around the world. Mohsin sailed with four other crew members – two British, two French – on *Musandam*, a 75 foot long trimaran (sailboat with three hulls). The trimaran had previously belonged to Dame Ellen MacArthur, a famous British yachtswoman who in February 2005 sailed solo around the world in record time. *Musandam* took 76 days to complete her voyage of 44,979 kilometres (24,287 nautical miles). She left Muttrah on January 8th 2009 and returned on March 25th 2009 to crowds of people waiting on Muttrah Corniche.

Musandam's Route

After leaving Muscat, *Musandam* sailed south and crossed the Equator. She then sailed round the southernmost part of the world, past the great Capes of Australia, South America and South Africa. She turned north, crossed the Equator again and headed back up to Muscat. Most of the trip was spent in the dangerous waters of the Southern Ocean where temperatures were often no higher than 3 degrees Centigrade, but often felt like minus 10 (-10) degrees Centigrade because of the cold wind.

During the journey, the crew battled against storms, freezing conditions and waves larger then houses. They faced the constant threat of danger from icebergs and whales. They saw land only twice – once in the Cook Strait, New Zealand, and once when going round Cape Horn in South America. But they did not set foot on

Reading for Pleasure

📖 Words from the story

voyage
رحلة بحرية

replica
نسخة طبق الأصل

crew
طاقم

trimaran
قارب بثلاثة هياكل

non-stop
دون توقف

Equator
خط الاستواء

kamal
أداة ملاحة عربية تقليدية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ In 1980 Tim Severin built Sohar, a replica of a ninth-century Omani dhow
- ✔ He wanted to show that Sindbad's voyage was possible and that Arabs had a great seafaring history
- ✔ Sohar sailed from Sur to Guangzhou in China, using the stars and the kamal, and arrived on 6 June 1981
- ✔ In 2009 Mohsin Al Busaidi became the first Arab to sail non-stop around the world, on the trimaran Musandam
- ✔ He sailed with four other crew members: they left Muscat on 8 January and returned on 25 March 2009, after 76 days
- ✔ Thousands welcomed them at Muttrah Corniche
- ✔ When reading for pleasure, enjoy the story and don't stop for every new word

🤔 Little questions

1. When did Musandam return?
   Answer: 25 March 2009
2. How many days did it take?
   Answer: 76
3. Where did Sohar sail to?
   Answer: Guangzhou, China
4. Did Mohsin sail alone?
   Answer: No, with a crew of five



Lesson 4-1 · Smart Homes

The House That Talks

A science-fiction comedy · Theme 4: Innovation

👥 The Al Harthy family, who move into a smart home in Muscat, and the youngest son, Omar

The Al Harthy family moved into a new house in Muscat. Omar, fifteen, was the first to walk in. Suddenly the lights came on and the air was cool.

"Welcome home, Omar," said a calm voice.

Omar jumped. "Who said that?"

"I am the house," said the voice. "This is a **smart home**."

How it works

Omar's father laughed. "It's a new **innovation**. In a smart home, computers control the lights, the temperature and the **appliances**."

Omar walked into the kitchen. The lights changed and the temperature went down.

"When you walk into a room," said the house, "I change the lights and temperature for you."

"And the fridge?"

"The fridge, the washing machine and other appliances **contain** computers connected by wires. I control them all."

> 💡 In a smart home, computers control lights, temperature and appliances, and they help save money.

The smart fridge

The next morning, Omar opened the fridge. A screen on the door said: Milk: finished. Eggs: two left. Please buy: milk, eggs, bread.

"The fridge tells you what food to buy!" said his mother. "And the **electronic** cupboards do the same."

Away from home

On Thursday, the family drove to Nizwa. In the car, Omar's father said, "Oh no! Did I leave the air conditioner on?"

He opened an app on his mobile phone. "Yes, it's on. I'll turn it off from here." He pressed a button.

"You can control the house with your phone when you are away?" said Omar.

"Yes. That's one of the best things about it."

Saving money

At the end of the month, the house spoke again. "Good evening. This month I turned off lights and air conditioners automatically when nobody was in the room. You saved 30 rials."

"How can a smart home save money?" asked Omar's little sister.

"It turns off lights and air conditioners when they are not needed," said Omar. "And it tells you how much money you are saving."

The trouble

But one night, there was a problem. Omar wanted a midnight snack. When he walked into the kitchen, the lights came on, very bright.

"Good evening, Omar," said the house loudly. "It is 12:30 a.m. You have school tomorrow. Shall I tell your mother?"

"No! No! Please!" Omar ran back to bed. Even a smart house can be too smart.

Word forms

For his homework, Omar made a table of word forms:

invent (verb) → invention (noun) → inventor (person) → inventive (adjective)

innovate (verb) → innovation (noun) → innovative (adjective)

"Be careful," said his teacher the next day. "Many students write inventer. The correct spelling is inventor."

Omar also wrote other new words: an **electronic device**, a machine like a phone or a tablet; an **improved** version, a better one; and **virtual reality**, a computer world that seems real.

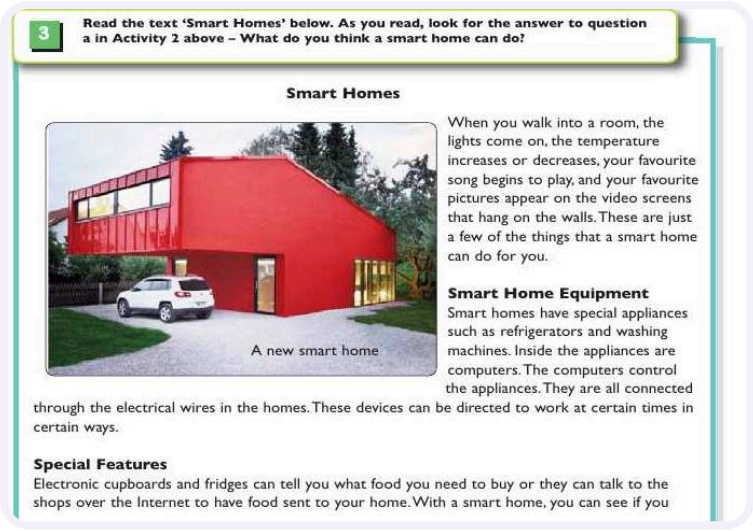
Extensive reading

His teacher gave one more tip: "Read 15 to 20 minutes a day of simple, interesting texts. This is called **extensive reading**. It will improve your reading."

That evening, Omar sat in his room with a short English story.

"Shall I make the light brighter for reading?" asked the house.

Omar smiled. "Yes, please. Thank you, house."



3 Read the text 'Smart Homes' below. As you read, look for the answer to question a in Activity 2 above – What do you think a smart home can do?

Smart Homes

A new smart home

When you walk into a room, the lights come on, the temperature increases or decreases, your favourite song begins to play, and your favourite pictures appear on the video screens that hang on the walls. These are just a few of the things that a smart home can do for you.

Smart Home Equipment

Smart homes have special appliances such as refrigerators and washing machines. Inside the appliances are computers. The computers control the appliances. They are all connected through the electrical wires in the homes. These devices can be directed to work at certain times in certain ways.

Special Features

Electronic cupboards and fridges can tell you what food you need to buy or they can talk to the shops over the Internet to have food sent to your home. With a smart home, you can see if you

Reading: Smart Homes

📖 Words from the story

innovation ابتكار	**invention** اختراع
appliance جهاز منزلي	**electronic device** جهاز إلكتروني
virtual reality الواقع الافتراضي	**improved** محسَّن
extensive reading القراءة الموسعة	

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Innovations and inventions change our lives
- ✔ In a smart home, lights and temperature change when you walk into a room
- ✔ Appliances like fridges and washing machines contain computers connected by wires
- ✔ smart fridges and cupboards tell you what food to buy
- ✔ You can control a smart home with a mobile phone when you are away
- ✔ It saves money by turning off lights and air conditioners automatically, and tells you how much you are saving
- ✔ Word forms: invent → invention → inventor → inventive
- ✔ innovate → innovation → innovative
- ✔ Read 15-20 minutes a day of simple, interesting texts (extensive reading)

🤔 Little questions

1. What does a smart fridge do?
   Answer: Tells you what food to buy
2. Noun from "invent"?
   Answer: Invention
3. Person who invents?
   Answer: Inventor
4. How can a smart home save money?
   Answer: It turns off lights and air conditioners when they are not needed



Lesson 4-2 · Questions and Answers + Past Passive

The Great Trivia Night

A quiz story Theme 4: Innovation

👥 The school trivia night: Team Comet (Adil and Hamdan) against Team Satellite (Jaber and Murad), with quizmaster Mr Hamed

The school hall was full. On the stage, two teams sat behind tables. Mr Hamed held a microphone.

"Welcome to **Trivia** Night! Trivia means facts about many different things. There's one rule tonight: all answers must use the **past passive**!"

The audience laughed.

The rule

"Quick reminder," said Mr Hamed. "Active: Edison invented the light bulb. Passive: The light bulb **was invented** by Edison. The form is **was** or **were** plus the **past participle**."

💡 Past passive = was / were + past participle. Example: The light bulb was invented by Edison.

Round one

"Question one: When was Sultan Qaboos University **established**?"

Adil pressed the button. "Sultan Qaboos University **was established** in **1986**!"

"Correct! One point to Team Comet."

"Question two: What happened to the old Roman city of Pompeii?"

Jaber pressed. "Pompeii **was destroyed** by a volcano!"

"Correct!"

"Question three: Who wrote the play Julius Caesar?"

Murad pressed. "Julius Caesar **was written** by William Shakespeare."

"Excellent!"

Round two: the doer or not?

"Now, why do we use the passive?" asked Mr Hamed. "First, when we want to emphasise the subject. For example: Three paintings were stolen yesterday. The paintings are more

important than the thief. Second, when we don't know who did something. Third, to give someone's date or place of birth. For example?"

Hamdan raised his hand. "My brother **was born** in Muscat."

"Good! And remember: use by + the doer only if it is important."

Round three: make it passive

"Change this sentence: Tim Berners-Lee invented the worldwide web."

Adil answered: "The worldwide web **was invented** by Tim Berners-Lee."

"Next: Marie Curie **discovered** radium."

Jaber was fast: "Radium **was discovered** by Marie Curie."

"Next: the first **satellite**, a machine that goes around the Earth, was sent into space in 1957. Is that sentence active or passive?"

"Passive!" shouted both teams.

The trap

"Last question, for three points! Is this sentence correct? The radio was invent in the 1890s."

Murad pressed quickly. "Correct!"

"I'm sorry, Murad. It's wrong."

Hamdan pressed. "It must be The radio was **invented**. With the passive, you need the past participle, not the base verb."

"Three points to Team Comet!"

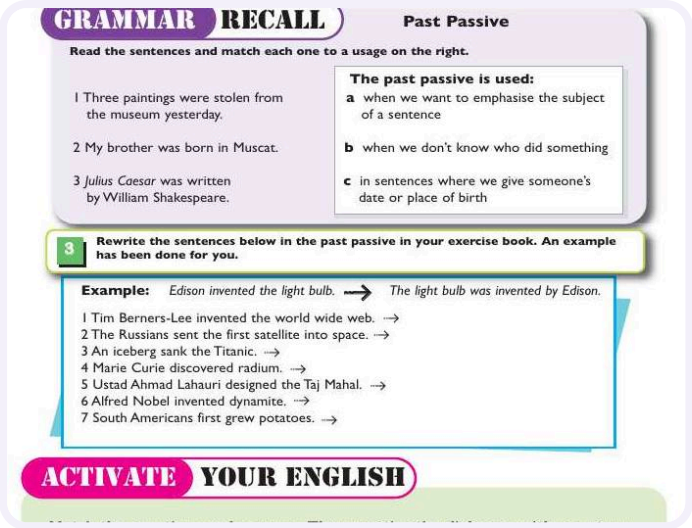
The result

The final score was close: Team Comet 9, Team Satellite 8. Mr Hamed gave the trophy to Adil and Hamdan.

"And now, a final sentence about tonight. Who can make it passive?"

Jaber smiled and took the microphone. "Tonight, a great quiz **was won** by Team Comet, and a lot of grammar **was learned** by everyone!"

The hall clapped loudly.



GRAMMAR RECALL

Past Passive

Read the sentences and match each one to a usage on the right.

1 Three paintings were stolen from the museum yesterday.

2 My brother was born in Muscat.

3 *Julius Caesar* was written by William Shakespeare.

The past passive is used:

a when we want to emphasise the subject of a sentence

b when we don't know who did something

c in sentences where we give someone's date or place of birth

3 Rewrite the sentences below in the past passive in your exercise book. An example has been done for you.

Example: *Edison invented the light bulb.* → *The light bulb was invented by Edison.*

1 Tim Berners-Lee invented the world wide web. →
2 The Russians sent the first satellite into space. →
3 An iceberg sank the Titanic. →
4 Marie Curie discovered radium. →
5 Ustad Ahmad Lahauri designed the Taj Mahal. →
6 Alfred Nobel invented dynamite. →
7 South Americans first grew potatoes. →

ACTIVATE YOUR ENGLISH

Grammar Recall: Past Passive

📖 Words from the story

trivia
معلومات عامة

satellite
قمر صناعي

discover
يكتشف

invent
يخترع

establish
يؤسس

destroy
يدمر

past participle
التصريف الثالث للفعل

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Past passive form: was / were + past participle
- ✔ Active: Edison invented the light bulb. Passive: The light bulb was invented by Edison.
- ✔ Use it to emphasise the subject (Three paintings were stolen yesterday.), when we don't know who did it, and for birth (My brother was born in Muscat.)
- ✔ Use "by" + the doer only if it is important
- ✔ Quiz facts: Sultan Qaboos University was established in 1986
- ✔ Pompeii was destroyed by a volcano
- ✔ Julius Caesar was written by Shakespeare
- ✔ Always use the past participle: "was invented", not "was invent"

🤔 Little questions

1. Form of the past passive?
   Answer: was/were + past participle
2. When was SQU established?
   Answer: 1986
3. Passive of "Marie Curie discovered radium"?
   Answer: Radium was discovered by Marie Curie
4. Correct this: "The radio was invent in ..."
   Answer: The radio was invented in ...



Lesson 4-3 · The Best and the Worst Inventions

The Inventions on Trial

A debate story · Theme 4: Innovation

👥 A class debate led by Mr Hamed, with Sultan for the "helpful" side and Khalfan for the "harmful" side

Mr Hamed wrote the title of an **essay** on the board: The Best and the Worst Inventions.

"Before you write," he said, "we'll have a debate. Sultan, your team defends the **helpful** inventions. Khalfan, your team accuses the **harmful** ones."

The helpful side

Sultan stood up. "Our first invention is **writing systems and paper**. Without them, we can't keep and share information. Every book in the world needs them.

Second, **money**. It makes businesses and services possible.

Third, **medicine**. Because of medicine, people live longer, healthier lives.

Fourth, **the wheel**. It is necessary for most types of **transportation**. Cars, buses, bicycles, planes on the runway: all need wheels."

Then his teammate added, "And from Oman: the **falaj**! It's another helpful invention. It brought water to our villages for thousands of years."

The class clapped.

💡 Helpful: writing and paper, money, medicine, the wheel, the falaj. Harmful: cigarettes, cars' pollution, guns, fast food, nuclear weapons.

The harmful side

Khalfan stood up with a serious face. "Our first invention is **cigarettes**. The **WHO**, the World Health Organization, says cigarettes kill millions of people every year.

Second, **cars**."

"Cars?" shouted Sultan. "Cars are helpful!"

"Let me finish," said Khalfan. "Cars cause **global warming**, the rise in the Earth's temperature because of pollution. And they cause road accidents.

Third, **guns**. They are designed to kill.

Fourth, **fast food**. It is harmful to our health.

And the worst: **nuclear weapons**. They can destroy whole cities."

The class was silent.

The middle ground

Mr Hamed spoke. "Sultan, you said cars are helpful. Khalfan, you said they're harmful. Who is right?"

Sultan thought. "Both of us. Cars help us travel, but they also pollute."

"Exactly," said Mr Hamed. "Don't think that every invention is only good or only bad. Many inventions have two sides."

Writing the essay

That evening, Khalfan started his essay. He used information from the debate. When he didn't know a word, he looked at the reading text again and found the specific information he needed.

> Some inventions are helpful. The wheel is helpful because it is necessary for most types of transportation. Medicine helps people live longer, healthier lives. However, some inventions are harmful. Cigarettes kill millions of people every year, according to the WHO...

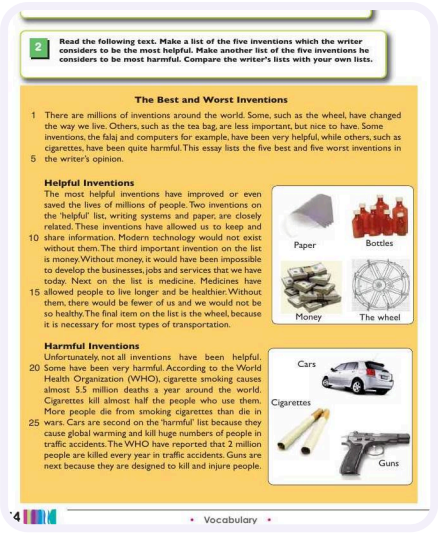
A tip for vocabulary

The next day, Mr Hamed gave the class advice. "Do you want more vocabulary? Read extensively. Choose texts at or below your level, so you can enjoy them. You'll learn words without trying."

❁ ❁ ❁

At the end of the week, the essays were on the wall. At the top, someone had written in big letters: The best invention? The falaj. The worst? Cigarettes.

Everyone agreed.



2 Read the following text. Make a list of the five inventions which the writer considers to be the most helpful. Make another list of the five inventions he considers to be most harmful. Compare the writer's lists with your own lists.

The Best and Worst Inventions

There are millions of inventions around the world. Some, such as the wheel, have changed the way we live. Others, such as the tea bag, are less important, but nice to have. Some inventions, the falaj and computers for example, have been very helpful, while others, such as cigarettes, have been quite harmful. This essay lists the five best and five worst inventions in the writer's opinion.

Helpful Inventions

The most helpful inventions have improved or even saved the lives of millions of people. Two inventions on the 'helpful' list, writing systems and paper, are closely related. These inventions have allowed us to keep and share information. Modern technology would not exist without them. The third important invention on the list is money. Without money, it would have been impossible to develop the businesses, jobs and services that we have today. Next on the list is medicine. Medicines have allowed people to live longer and be healthier. Without them, there would be fewer of us and we would not be so healthy. The final item on the list is the wheel, because it is necessary for most types of transportation.

Paper Bottles Money The wheel

Harmful Inventions

Unfortunately, not all inventions have been helpful. Some have been very harmful. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), cigarette smoking causes almost 5.5 million deaths a year around the world. Cigarettes kill almost half the people who use them. More people die from smoking cigarettes than die in wars. Cars are second on the 'harmful' list because they cause global warming and kill huge numbers of people in traffic accidents. The WHO have reported that 2 million people are killed every year in traffic accidents. Guns are next because they are designed to kill and injure people.

Cars Cigarettes Guns

4 • Vocabulary •

Reading: The Best and Worst Inventions

📖 Words from the story

harmful
ضار

helpful
نافع

global warming
الاحتباس الحراري

nuclear weapon
سلاح نووي

essay
مقال

transportation
النقل

WHO (World Health Organization)
منظمة الصحة العالمية

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Helpful inventions: writing systems and paper (keep and share information), money (businesses and services), medicine (longer, healthier lives), the wheel (needed for most transportation), and the falaj
- ✔ Harmful inventions: cigarettes kill millions every year (WHO), cars cause global warming and road accidents, guns are designed to kill, fast food harms health, nuclear weapons destroy cities
- ✔ Many inventions have two sides: cars help us travel but also pollute
- ✔ Find specific information in a reading text to support your ideas
- ✔ Read extensively and choose texts at or below your level to build vocabulary

🤔 Little questions

1. Name a helpful invention

   Answer: Paper

2. Why are cars harmful?

   Answer: Global warming and accidents

3. What is the WHO?

   Answer: World Health Organization

4. Why is the wheel helpful?

   Answer: It is necessary for most types of transportation



Lesson 4-4 · Virtual Reality + Indirect Questions

Inside the Headset

A science-fiction story Theme 4: Innovation

👥 Hamad, who visits a virtual reality lab at a technology fair, and the engineer Mr Salim

At the technology fair in Muscat, Hamad stood in front of a strange stand. A young engineer, Mr Salim, smiled at him.

"Would you like to try our **virtual reality** headset?"

Hamad wanted to ask What is virtual reality?, but he remembered his English lesson. He asked politely:

"**Can you tell me what virtual reality is?**"

"Of course. It is an **interactive** computer environment. It can copy the real world, or create **fictional** worlds that don't really exist."

💡 Indirect questions are polite. Word order: question phrase + subject + verb. "Can you tell me what virtual reality is?"

Inside the headset

Hamad put on the headset. Suddenly he was in the cockpit of a plane, high above the clouds.

"This programme **simulates** flying," said Mr Salim. "It copies the real experience. We use it for training pilots. Doctors train with it too. They practise operations before they work on real people."

Hamad pressed a button and the plane turned. "It feels real!"

More uses

Next, he was in a museum in another country. He walked between statues and paintings.

"This is a virtual museum tour," said Mr Salim. "You can visit museums without travelling."

Then he was standing in an empty building with no walls.

"This building isn't built yet," said Mr Salim. "Architects design buildings with **CAD**, **Computer Assisted Design**. With VR, they can walk inside before it is built."

"**Could you give me some examples** of fictional worlds?" asked Hamad.

"Computer games are the best example."

The limitations

Hamad took off the headset. "**Do you know when virtual reality began?**"

"The first ideas came many years ago, but it is still developing. And it has **limitations**."

"What are they?"

"It's hard to make it feel completely real. And computers and the Internet are not yet powerful enough for everything we want."

A mistake

Hamad's friend Ali came to the stand. "Excuse me, do you know where is the exit?"

Mr Salim smiled. "It's over there. But in an indirect question, we say, Do you know where the exit **is**? The verb comes after the subject."

Ali laughed. "Thank you, teacher!"

Listening at the talk

At four o'clock, Mr Salim gave a talk about VR. Hamad remembered the listening tips his teacher taught him: think about the topic before listening; listen for the information you want; don't expect to understand everything. He didn't understand every word, but he understood the main points.

During the talk, Mr Salim asked the audience how often they played computer games, and he used **adverbs of frequency**: "Do you always, usually, sometimes or never play?"

Hamad answered honestly: "I sometimes play, but I usually read."

❁ ❁ ❁

On the way out, Hamad saw a sign: Ask us anything! He walked to the desk and asked his best indirect question of the day:

"Can you tell me what time the fair closes tomorrow?"

"At nine p.m.," said the woman. "And that was a perfect question!"



Sound Bites: Indirect Questions

📖 Words from the story

interactive
تفاعلي

fictional
خيالي

limitation
قيد / حدود

CAD (Computer Assisted Design)
التصميم بمساعدة الحاسوب

simulate
يحاكي

adverbs of frequency
ظروف التكرار

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Virtual reality is an interactive computer environment that can copy the real world or create fictional worlds
- ✔ Uses: training pilots and doctors, virtual museum tours, designing buildings with CAD
- ✔ fictional worlds: computer games
- ✔ Limitations: hard to make it feel real
- ✔ computers and the Internet are not yet powerful enough
- ✔ Indirect questions: Can you tell me what VR is? Do you know when it began? Could you give some examples ...?
- ✔ Word order: question phrase + subject + verb ("where the station is", not "where is the station")
- ✔ Listening tips: think about the topic first, listen for the information you want, don't expect to understand everything

🤔 Little questions

1. Give a use of VR

   Answer: Training pilots

2. What is CAD?

   Answer: Computer Assisted Design

3. Is this correct: "Can you tell me what time it is?"

   Answer: Yes, correct

4. Make indirect: "Where is the museum?"

   Answer: Can you tell me where the museum is?



Lesson 4-5 · E-Shopping and a Complaint E-mail

The Wrong Size

A story with an e-mail Theme 4: Innovation

👥 Murad, who buys shoes online, and his older sister's husband, Khalil, who helps him complain

Murad wanted new football boots. The shop in the mall was expensive, so he looked online.

"Look!" he said to his brother-in-law, Khalil. "Half price! I'll buy them now."

"Wait," said Khalil. "Did you read the **terms and conditions**?"

"The what?"

"The rules of the website. Before you buy online, you must read them."

Reading the rules

Murad scrolled down. The text was long and small.

1. To buy, you need a **membership**. Membership costs 5 rials a year.
2. If an item is **faulty**, you can return it within 14 days.
3. We do not give a **refund** for the wrong size if you chose it.

"Hmm, so if I choose the wrong size, it's my problem," said Murad.

"Exactly. That's a risk of **e-shopping**: you can't see or touch the product. You can get the wrong size, or a faulty item."

💡 E-shopping risks: you can't see or touch the product, you may get the wrong size or a faulty item, and you must pay safely and never share your password.

Paying safely

Murad chose size 42 carefully and went to the payment page.

"Pay only on safe websites," said Khalil. "And never share your password with anyone."

The problem

Ten days later, a box arrived. Murad opened it happily. But one boot was size 42, and the other was size 44! And the sole of one boot was broken.

"They're faulty!" Murad shouted. "I'll write them an angry message!"

"Stop," said Khalil calmly. "Stay polite and clear, even when you are angry. Let's write a formal **e-mail of complaint**."

Writing the complaint

They sat at the computer. Khalil explained each part.

"Opening: you don't know the person's name, so write Dear Sir or Madam.

Purpose: say why you are writing.

Details: what you ordered and what went wrong.

Request: what you want them to do.

Ending: because you began with Dear Sir or Madam, you finish with Yours faithfully and your full name."

Murad typed:

Subject: Faulty football boots, order number 5521

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to inform you that I am **dissatisfied** with the football boots I ordered from your website on 3 October.

I ordered size 42. However, one boot is size 42 and the other is size 44. Also, the sole of one boot is broken.

According to your terms and conditions, I can return faulty items within 14 days. I would like to return the boots and receive a full refund. Please reply as soon as possible.

Yours faithfully,

Murad Saif Al Rawahi

A last check

"Should I write Love, Murad at the end?" joked Murad.

Khalil laughed. "Never in a formal e-mail! Yours faithfully."

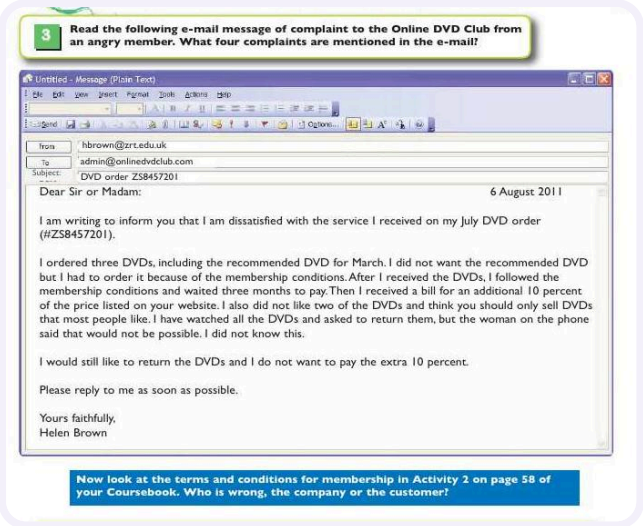
The answer

Two days later, an e-mail arrived:

Dear Mr Al Rawahi, We are very sorry. We will send you a new pair and refund the delivery cost.

Murad smiled. "So a polite **complaint** works better than an angry one!"

"Always," said Khalil.



An e-mail of complaint

📖 Words from the story

terms and conditions
الشروط والأحكام

membership
عضوية

dissatisfied
غير راضٍ

faulty
معيب

complain
يشتكي

refund
استرداد المال

Yours faithfully
وتفضلوا بقبول فائق الاحترام

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Buying online is easy but has risks: you can't see or touch the product, and you may get the wrong size or faulty items
- ✔ Pay online safely and never share your password
- ✔ Read the terms and conditions before you buy
- ✔ Complaint e-mail: Opening "Dear Sir or Madam," then purpose: "I am writing to inform you that I am dissatisfied with ..."
- ✔ Then details (what you ordered, what went wrong) and request ("I would like to return ... Please reply as soon as possible.")
- ✔ End with "Yours faithfully," + full name, never "Love"
- ✔ Stay polite and clear, even when you are angry

🤔 Little questions

1. How do you end a letter that begins "Dear Sir or Madam"?
   Answer: Yours faithfully
2. "Faulty" means?
   Answer: Not working correctly
3. One risk of e-shopping
   Answer: Wrong or faulty items
4. Start a complaint about a late order
   Answer: Dear Sir or Madam, I am writing to complain that the book I ordered has not arrived.



Lesson 4-6 · Reading for Pleasure: Omani Invention, Paper from Palm Leaves

The Smoke Over the Palm Trees

An inspiring true-life story Theme 4: Innovation

👥 The school radio team interviews a young Omani inventor, Mustafa Barami from Salalah (based on the textbook interview)

Every year in the farms of Oman, farmers cut old leaves from their date palms. For many years, they burned them. Smoke went up into the sky.

A young man from **Salalah** watched this smoke and thought: What a waste! And what **pollution**!

His name was **Mustafa Salim Abdullah Barami**. He was a student of chemistry at **Sultan Qaboos University**.

The interview

The school radio team invited Mustafa to an interview. Before the interview, the presenter, Waleed, gave his team a tip: "In an interview text, read the questions first. Then you can find information quickly."

Waleed: Mustafa, welcome! How did your idea start?

Mustafa: About **3 million tonnes** of palm waste were burned each year in Oman. It caused a lot of pollution. I asked myself: can we use these leaves for something useful?

Waleed: And what did you find?

Mustafa: Paper! Paper is made mostly of **cellulose**. Date palm leaves contain **35% to 45%** cellulose. That's a lot, so they are good for making paper.

> 💡 Date palm leaves contain 35%-45% cellulose, the main content of paper, so they are good for making paper.

Waleed: How do you make it?

Mustafa: In the lab, I cut the leaves and cook them with water and chemicals. They become a soft wet mixture called **pulp**. Then I press the pulp into thin sheets and dry them. And we have paper!

Waleed: Many people think paper can only be made from wood.

Mustafa: That's a mistake. It can also be made from palm leaves.

The award

Waleed: I heard you won a prize.

Mustafa: Yes. I entered an invention fair, a **competition** in **Kuwait**, and I won a silver **award**. I was very proud to represent Oman.

The benefits

Waleed: Why is your invention good for the **environment**?

Mustafa: There are three **environmental** benefits. First, there is less pollution from burning leaves. Second, paper bags can replace plastic bags. Third, it saves the world's forests, because we don't need to cut so many trees.

Across cultures: Malaysia

After the interview, Waleed read a short "Across Cultures" fact file about another country that loves palm trees: **Malaysia**.

> Capital: **Kuala Lumpur**. Famous buildings: the **Petronas Towers**. Nature: rainforests and rare animals like **orang-utans**. Religion: mostly **Islam**.

"Malaysia has many palm trees too," said Waleed. "Maybe one day they will make paper like Mustafa!"

❁ ❁ ❁

That evening, Waleed walked past a farm near his house. A farmer was collecting old palm leaves.

"Are you going to burn them, uncle?"

"Of course. What else can I do?"

Waleed smiled. "Let me tell you about a young man from Salalah..."



Omani Invention: Making Paper out of Palm Leaves

📖 Words from the story

cellulose السليلوز	**pulp** لب الورق
environmental بيئي	**award** جائزة
pollution تلوث	**competition** مسابقة

🌟 What did I learn?

- ✔ Mustafa Salim Abdullah Barami from Salalah studied chemistry at SQU
- ✔ About 3 million tonnes of palm waste were burned each year, causing pollution
- ✔ Date palm leaves contain 35%-45% cellulose, the main content of paper, so they are good for paper
- ✔ He won a silver award at an invention fair in Kuwait
- ✔ Benefits: less pollution, paper bags can replace plastic bags, and it saves the world's forests
- ✔ Paper can be made from palm leaves, not only from wood
- ✔ Malaysia: capital Kuala Lumpur, Petronas Towers, rainforests and orang-utans, mostly Islam
- ✔ In an interview text, read the questions first to find information quickly

🤔 Little questions

1. Where is Mustafa from?
   Answer: Salalah
2. What does paper mostly contain?
   Answer: Cellulose

3. Capital of Malaysia?

   Answer: Kuala Lumpur

4. Why are palm leaves good for paper?

   Answer: They contain a lot of cellulose